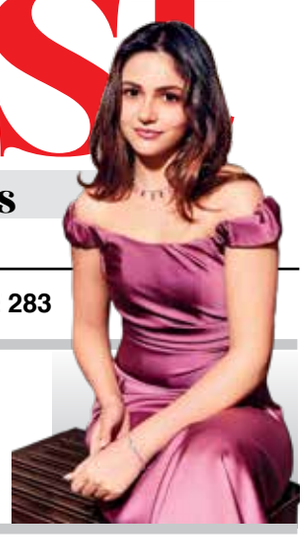
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No Half Truths

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CM REKHA DRAWS LINE ON PROTESTS, PUBLIC DAMAGE P3



CJP LEADERS VOW TO PROTEST TILL GYANESH KUMAR RESIGNS P5

'I'M GRATEFUL OUR PATHS CROSSED' P12

TOP COURT SAYS THERE MUST BE NO ILLEGAL DETENTION

SC order fails to stop detentions

Police crackdown on protesters continues as over 200 detained, CJP vows to intensify stir

NARESH BISWANI, ANAMTA FATIMA & PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, October 11

More than 200 protesters were detained as they chanted slogans and marched towards the Jantar Mantar on Sunday as the protest called by the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) entered its second day amid heavy security deployment across the capital. The CJP said it would continue its agitation until the Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar resigns.

Despite a Supreme Court order against illegal detentions and removal of barricades, chaotic scenes unfolded in the New Delhi district as students and activists protested against the Election Commission. Showing scant respect for the apex court order earlier in the day, Delhi police continued their crackdown till late evening, apprehending people, including journalists. The implementation of the top court order was hardly visible on the ground as protesters and even bystanders were detained and pushed into buses.



Police personnel detain protestors in New Delhi, on Sunday PTI

ON THE STREETS

- AISA president Neha Bora detained at Connaught Place
- CJP leaders Dipke, Ranka and Das released with conditions
- SFI alleges women protesters illegally detained after 6 pm
- Journalists detained despite displaying valid press cards
- CJP leader Saurav Das alleges phones seized without memos
- Three Indian Express Hindi journalists detained, later released
- Hindu journalist briefly detained, released before bus departed
- Over 70 people held outside Press Club of India
- Around 100 protesters packed into two buses



Earlier in the day, CJP leaders Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das were released on the condition that they would not "breach peace" for a year.

At a press conference, Das claimed that Delhi Police officials took away their phones during their detention without issuing any seizure memo, raising concerns that the devices may have been hacked or cloned to CONTINUED ON P4

AT THE COURT

- SC bars illegal detention of peaceful protesters
- Centre told to ensure normal Delhi Metro operations
- Internet services must remain undisturbed, subject to law
- Lawyers, journalists must be allowed to perform duties
- SC orders removal of Section 163 notice board near court
- SC issues notice to Centre on contempt plea



'VOTE CHORI' ALLEGATIONS

CJI declines INDIA bloc's request for meeting today

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant has not agreed to meet Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and Leader of Opposition in the Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge, who had sought an appointment on Monday to raise allegations of "vote chori", sources said on Sunday night. The two leaders had requested a meeting between 4 pm and 5 pm to submit a memorandum seeking an end to alleged electoral irregularities, the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, a halt to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls and a return to paper ballots.

In response to Rahul Gandhi's request for a meeting, CJI Surya Kant said that no orders can be passed on the administrative side, and asked the Congress leader to file a petition on the judicial side that may be taken up on Tuesday, the sources said.

The CJI said the Supreme Court is open 24x7 for all citizens if their fundamental rights are violated, they added.

He also said the Supreme Court cannot interfere with the functions of the executive on the administrative side, the sources said.

A source said the CJI's response to their letters had been sent to their official email addresses but did not elaborate. Opposition parties had earlier announced a march to the Supreme Court on Monday under the Congress campaign slogan "Chalo Delhi: March for Democracy". However, there was no immediate CONTINUED ON P4



KEY POINTS

- LoPs sought appointment between 4 pm and 5 pm on Monday
- Memorandum sought CEC Gyanesh Kumar's resignation, halt to SIR
- Opposition also demanded end to alleged 'vote chori' and return to paper ballots
- INDIA bloc had announced 'Chalo Delhi: March for Democracy' at 1.30 pm
- No official word on march after CJI's response

PM inaugurates Rs 13,000-crore projects in Tamil Nadu, vows to work with CM Vijay

Says infra projects will improve travel, boost trade and industry, and create jobs

MPOST BUREAU
Chennai, October 11

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday inaugurated and laid the foundation stone for infrastructure projects worth around Rs 13,000 crore in Tamil Nadu, pledging to work with Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay to accelerate the state's development. The projects cover railways, roads and petroleum infrastructure, with the prime minister saying that his commitment to serving the people would remain unchanged despite political transitions.



> GOVERNMENTS MAY CHANGE, BUT MY RESOLVE FOR TAMIL NADU'S DEVELOPMENT, SERVING ITS PEOPLE REMAINS STEADFAST

Addressing a gathering after the inauguration, Modi said development had always been his guiding principle and that he understood the aspirations of states from his experience as Gujarat chief minister. He said his approach as prime minister had been to help states achieve their development goals.

"Governments may change, but my resolve for Tamil Nadu's CONTINUED ON P4

Manipur: Situation remains tense, toll rises to 9

MPOST BUREAU
Imphal, October 11

The death toll from a fresh round of violence between Kuki and Naga communities in Manipur's hill districts has risen to nine, with tensions persisting on Sunday despite the deployment of additional security forces. Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh condemned the killings, appealed for restraint and directed officials to take immediate steps to restore peace and protect civilians.

The latest killings were reported in Kamjong, Kangpokpi and Ukhrul districts on Friday and Saturday. In a social media post, Singh said, "I condemn the killing of innocent civilians and the violence." He said authorities had been instructed to take effective measures to control the situation and restore law and order.

The violence began after unidentified gunmen shot dead a 22-year-old woman, a mother of five, in Chassad village in CONTINUED ON P4

INDIAN NATIONAL KILLED

'Completely unacceptable': India condemns attack on Saudi Airport

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 11

India on Sunday condemned a missile attack on Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport that killed 12 people and injured more than 300, calling for an immediate end to strikes targeting civilians and civilian infrastructure in Saudi Arabia. An Indian national was among the dead, and 10 others were injured.

In a statement, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) denounced repeated attacks on the airport, including the October 10 strike, which caused casualties and property damage.

"The repeated attacks on civilians and civilian infrastructure are completely unacceptable and must cease immediately," the ministry said, expressing condolences to the families of those killed and wishing the injured a speedy recovery.

India also voiced solidarity with Saudi Arabia in defending its sovereignty and expressed hope that peace and normalcy would return to the region soon.
CONTINUED ON P4

GIVES NO DETAILS

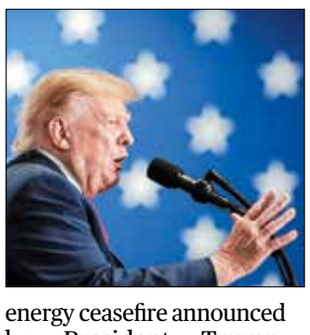
Trump says Russia, Ukraine reach 'energy ceasefire'

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, October 11

US President Donald Trump said Sunday that Russia and Ukraine had agreed to an "energy ceasefire," but offered no details on its terms.

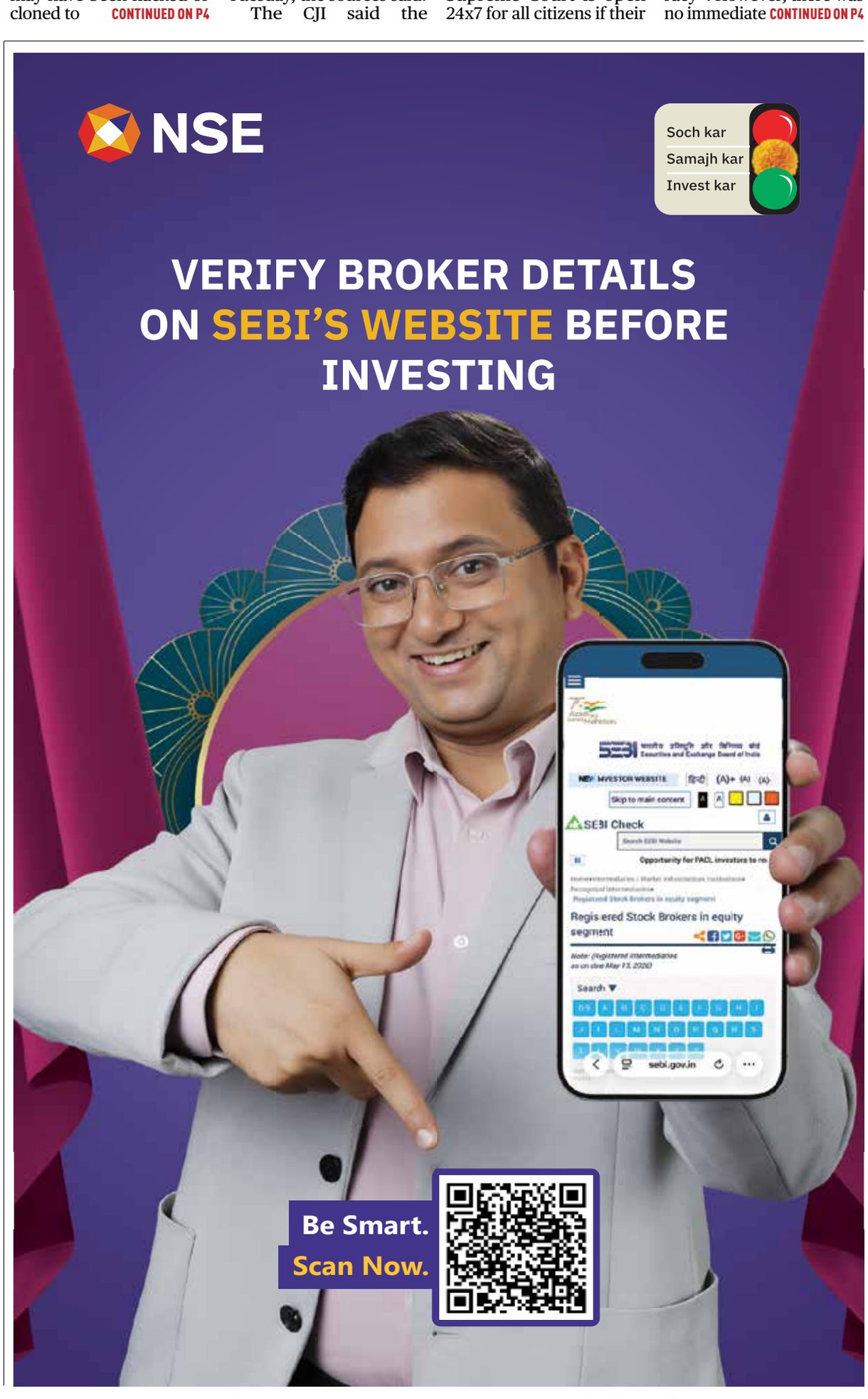
Trump's brief social media post said only that the ceasefire took effect immediately and that both sides had agreed to it. "Do not break it!" he wrote.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on X: "We discussed the energy ceasefire announced by President Trump. Ukraine supports the ceasefire, and it is important that Russia support it as well. We are awaiting details from the American side." Zelenskyy added that he had spoken with Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney, Finnish President Alexander Stubb and NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte.
CONTINUED ON P4



TAKEAWAYS

- Moscow and the White House have yet to clarify the announcement
- Zelenskyy offers to stop strikes on Russian refineries if Moscow halts attacks on Ukraine's energy infrastructure



4 ALLEGEDLY LINKED TO HINDU RAKSHA DAL; ACCUSED OF ASSAULTING PROTESTER

From viral video to police net: Four held

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, October 11



HIGHLIGHTS

- The men have been identified as Raman Saini (50), Vivekanand (32), Kapil Kumar (27) and Ravinder Singh, alias Govind Hindu
- All four are residents of the Delhi-NCR region and are allegedly associated with the Hindu Raksha Dal

Delhi Police has arrested four men for allegedly assaulting a man outside the site of the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) proposed protest in central Delhi on Saturday. The accused were identified through videos of the incident that surfaced on social media.

The men have been identified as Raman Saini (50), Vivekanand (32), Kapil Kumar (27) and Ravinder Singh, alias Govind Hindu. All four are residents of the Delhi-NCR region and are allegedly associated with the Hindu Raksha Dal, led by Bhupendra Tomar, also known as Pinki Chaudhary.

Police traced the accused through their social media accounts. "The Kamla Market police station took suo motu cognisance of a video circulating on social media showing four men allegedly assaulting a man and registered a case," a Delhi Police spokesperson said.

Chaudhary later acknowledged social media posts by members of his organisation, who identified themselves as Hindu Raksha Dal workers and threatened to reach Jantar Mantar. Police detained him at his residence in Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh, on Saturday.

Posts on Chaudhary's X account showed members and supporters of his organisation confronting CJP protesters at several locations in central Delhi. One of the posts featured a video of the alleged assault, along with images of police personnel, and questioned their failure to intervene.

CJP accused BJP and RSS activists of attempting to disrupt its protest. In one of its posts, the party also alleged that a police officer had instructed someone to stop filming, claiming that the police appeared to be helping the BJP and RSS.

The protest was called against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, but police had denied permission for the gathering. Security was tightened across central Delhi, with police detaining CJP protesters and restricting access to several areas. The arrests come amid days of tension between CJP and BJP, with both sides accusing each other of inciting violence and mistreating protesters.

2 protesters, 1 charge: Assault and Threats

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE, SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 11

> PROTESTERS ALLEGED THAT A CAR CARRYING PEOPLE ARMED WITH LATHIS SPED TOWARDS DEMONSTRATORS, ACCUSING DELHI POLICE OF BIAS IN HANDLING DETENTIONS



A 17-year-old boy and a 34-year-old woman protester accused on Sunday that they were assaulted and threatened by people allegedly affiliated with right-wing groups at Connaught Place, amidst tightened security and restrictions in central Delhi.

Separately, protesters alleged a car carrying people with lathis was being driven at high speed near demonstrators, accusing Delhi Police of partiality in handling detentions. Police, however, denied allegations of partiality in handling detentions.

Sources allege that the 17-year-old minor was talking to a media about the ongoing political controversy around Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, when a group of people allegedly chased and thrashed him.

"I was talking against CEC Gyanesh Kumar, saying that he is a puppet of the Prime Minister of India and that he will not let him resign," the boy said, adding that an alleged right wing mob chased and assaulted him after he finished talking to the media.

In another incident, a 34-year-old woman accused a man belonging to a right wing group of detaining her friend, leading to a confrontation.

She also claimed that another individual allegedly from right-wing threatened and assaulted her during the incident while other alleged Bajrang Dal members joined in the assault.

She further alleged that Delhi Police transferred one of the accused to a separate vehicle bearing registration number DLIVC 6234 and claimed that none of the detainees were inside it.

Giving reasons for the decision to move the accused, a senior police officer reportedly said that keeping the person in the same vehicle would lead to a clash among those detained.

"They might get into a clash inside the bus if we keep the alleged person in the same bus," the officer said.

Meanwhile, in another incident, some protesters alleged that a car carrying people affiliated with right wing groups was found to be with lathis and was being driven at high speed near the demonstration site.

According to them, one demonstrator tried to hit the vehicle to stop it by questioning why a car allegedly carrying people with lathis was being driven so fast. The protesters accused Delhi Police of protecting right wing supporters and taking action against demonstrators.

They questioned why people allegedly carrying lathis or involved in assaults were not being detained in the same manner as protesters.

A senior Delhi Police official denied allegations of partiality in the detention process, rejecting claims that right wing supporters were being given preferential treatment.

I was not detained, I was 'kidnapped', says Rathee

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11



YouTuber Dhruv Rathee on Sunday claimed he was "kidnapped" from his residence by people in plain clothes and taken to different police stations ahead of the planned protest against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar in Delhi on October 10. In a video posted on X, Rathee said around 20 people in plain clothes entered his house around 7 am on Saturday while he was sleeping. He claimed they took him away before he could ask who they were.

Rathee said he was taken to different police stations and was not allowed to contact his lawyer or access a phone for around 22-23 hours. He also claimed he sustained injuries while being taken out of his bedroom. "I was not detained, I was kidnapped," he said, describing his experience and questioning the manner in which he was taken from his residence.

Addressing rumours about his citizenship, Rathee displayed his passport in the video and asserted that he is an Indian citizen. He also rejected claims that he had not intended to participate in the protest. Rathee was detained at his Gurugram residence ahead of the Cockroach Janta Party's proposed protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10.

The demonstration was called to demand the CEC's resignation over concerns about the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.

In the video, Rathee criticised the restrictions imposed ahead of the protest and described the situation as an "unofficial emergency". He said he would continue to raise his voice on issues concerning the country.

Police video counters CJP's claim over Dipke's grandmother's death

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11



The Delhi Police on Sunday released a video showing CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke being told about his grandmother's death as it refuted the claim that he had not been conveyed the news while in custody on October 10.

It reiterated that the news was conveyed with due sensitivity and assistance was offered for his travel to his hometown for the funeral, but he "declined" the offer.

It said the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) has accused the Delhi Police of not relaying the information. The video comes after Dipke's mother accused the Delhi Police of lying, alleging that her son had not been informed about his grandmother's demise on Saturday. CJP leader Ashutosh Ranka, however, has accused the authorities of displaying insensitivity when Dipke was informed about the death.

Showing a video, Deputy Commissioner of Police (PRO) Neha Yadav said at a press conference that the information was promptly conveyed to Dipke, who was also informed about the scheduled funeral time.

"He was also offered all possible assistance to facilitate his travel to his hometown on humanitarian grounds; however, he declined to avail the same," she said, adding that he was also extended the offer to speak with his family.

In the video played at the press conference, a woman in police uniform and a man in plain clothes can be seen talking to Dipke, who's sitting in a room. As the CJP leader covers his face with his hands, the man can be seen offering water to him.

Dipke's grandmother, who had been ill for a long time, died on Saturday at around 11.30 am in Maharashtra's Hingoli. He was among the three CJP leaders detained by the Delhi Police from inside an aircraft on Saturday ahead of its protest at Jantar Mantar. Police had denied permission for the protest, citing procedural requirements and prohibitory orders in force in the New Delhi area.

Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das were placed under preventive arrest following their detention. They were released on Sunday morning after being produced before an executive magistrate. The three were released on the condition that they would not "breach peace" for a year, CJP legal affairs head Ratna Singh said. In a statement, the CJP had described their release as a "major legal victory".

Man dies after assault over seat inside Metro; ex-civil servant & son booked

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 11

A 48-year-old man died after he was allegedly slapped and pushed during a dispute over a senior citizen seat inside a metro at the Supreme Court station here, with police registering a case against a former IAS officer and his son, officials said.

The incident took place on October 8, when the deceased, Pawan Sharma, was allegedly assaulted by the two accused, identified as Sanjay Pratap Singh and his son Sidharth Singh, inside the train, according to the FIR registered at the Supreme Court Metro police station.

Sources said the altercation reportedly began over a seat reserved for senior citizens. Sharma was allegedly slapped and pushed during the argument, causing him to fall on the floor of the train and sustain injuries to his head. The metro staff took Sharma to the Lok Nayak Jai Prakash Hospital in an ambulance, where he was declared dead, according to the FIR.

The case was registered on October 9 on a complaint by Sharma's mother, Durga Sharma, under Section 105 (culpable homicide not amounting to murder) and 3 (5) (common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), the FIR said. Police sources said Sanjay Pratap Singh is a former senior IAS officer who was earlier arrested by the Central Bureau of Investigation in an alleged bribery case.

One-year-old boy run over by tractor in Fbd

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Faridabad, October 11

A one-year-old boy was killed after being run over by a tractor carrying a water tanker while playing outside his home in Faridabad's Sector 86, police said on Sunday.

The incident took place around 5 pm on Saturday, two days before the child's first birthday. The tractor driver has been arrested, they said.

The child's father, Jitendra, a native of Madhya Pradesh who works at a construction site in Faridabad, said his son Rahul was playing by the roadside while he was inside their room.

Hearing children shouting outside, Jitendra rushed out and found that his son had been hit by the tractor. The vehicle was being reversed when a wheel ran over Rahul's head, killing him on the spot, he said.

An FIR was registered at the Kheri Pul police station, and the accused driver, identified as Rajkumar, was arrested, police said.

The child's body was handed over to the family after a postmortem examination. An investigation into the incident is underway, a senior police officer said.

Woman killed, husband critical as Fortuner runs over sleeping couple Ggm

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11

A 63-year-old woman was killed and her husband critically injured after being run over by a speeding SUV while they were sleeping near Airia Mall on Sohna Road here on Sunday morning, police said.

The deceased, identified as Chirnji Devi, was a resident of Mahoba district in Uttar Pradesh. Her husband, Natthu Ram, 66, is undergoing treatment at a hospital, they said.

The accident occurred around 5 am when the driver of the SUV (Toyota Fortuner) – travelling from Badshahpur towards Sohna – allegedly lost control of the vehicle, mounted the pavement and hit the couple.

After running them over, the vehicle allegedly continued ahead and crashed into a crane parked on the footpath. The airbags deployed upon impact, police said.

According to eyewitnesses, a man and a woman were inside the Fortuner. Both allegedly fled the scene after the accident, leaving the vehicle behind.

The injured couple was taken to a hospital, where Devi succumbed to her injuries, while her husband remained in critical condition, police said.

An FIR was registered at Badshahpur police station based on a complaint filed by the couple's son, Kailash Kumar.

Police impounded the damaged SUV and are trying to identify its occupants.

NETWORKS FORMED ON SOCIAL MEDIA

From legal to first aid, support mobilised for CJP protesters

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11



As thousands of protesters were detained across Delhi during the CJP agitation over two days, a network of volunteers, doctors, lawyers and social media influencers has stepped forward to help, offering everything from medical assistance to legal aid for the demonstrators.

The support to detainees and their families has been offered both by individuals, as well as coordinated volunteer groups, who are amplifying social media appeals to connect them with relevant resources.

A CJP volunteer, in a social media post, said more than 130 people were now working on a protest support initiative after a meeting of volunteers who had helped protesters during Saturday's agitation.

"We have about 130-plus people working on this initiative now. So I thought it was time to just turn it into a thing," the volunteer said in a video outlining plans to bring different support groups together.

The initiative includes a "Detainee Ghar Wapsi Yojana", aimed at arranging transport and supplies for people returning home after being released from custody, and the Immediate Response First Aid Network (IRFAN), which brings together doctors and volunteers to help injured protesters.

Another initiative, called PAUSE, or People Are Under Systemic Exhaustion, has been developed to connect people experiencing trauma and exhaustion with therapists offering mental health support, according to the volunteer.

The volunteer also announced plans for a scouting team to gather information from the ground, a creator network to keep journalists and others updated about developments at different locations NCR region, as protesters taken into custody were being moved to different locations, including stadiums and hospitals.

"We are going to be more efficient so that wherever you are, we are there," the volunteer said, adding that the group would do its best to ensure protesters received support.

Beyond organised initiatives, individual social media users have also been offering help. One user, identifying themselves as a doctor, said they wanted to assist injured protesters and would be available near Gurdwara Bangla Sahib.

Others, including volunteers and legal professionals, have offered their contact details for circulation among protesters and their families, while the social media platform, Instagram, has become the centre for assistance coordination. The efforts come as protesters and their supporters navigate a massive deployment of security personnel in the national capital. On Saturday, Delhi Police prevented demonstrators from reaching Jantar Mantar, where the proposed gathering had been denied permission.

and an information network to collect updates and pass them on to those who need them.

A legal aid network is also being set up to connect detained protesters and their families with lawyers.

"The lawyers, we need you," the volunteer said, appealing to more legal professionals to join the initiative.

The group is also working to bring together people who have started similar efforts independently. A central command and designated points of contact for each initiative are being planned to coordinate assistance.

The volunteer said the network's reach had expanded beyond the protest site to the wider Delhi-

AAP questions SIR process

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, October 11

The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Sunday questioned the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process, alleging that 16 lakh names were to be deleted from electoral rolls in Bengal and claiming that Form 6 was modified without the government's knowledge.

The party questioned how the deletions were being carried out and how Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar was overseeing the process, while alleging vote theft.

However, AAP said it would not undertake any independent verification to establish whether the SIR process was fair. The party also accused the BJP led government of imposing an "undeclared Emergency" in Delhi following the police crackdown on protesters heading to Jantar Mantar on Saturday to demand Gyanesh Kumar's resignation.

Addressing a press conference, AAP Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Singh alleged that police dragged and assaulted youths, women, journalists and lawyers and detained thousands of people, including Arvind Kejriwal, three other former chief ministers and senior CJP leaders.

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PRAYS AT JHANDEWALA TEMPLE ON NAVRATRI

CM Rekha draws line on protests, public damage



AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, October 11

A day after protests disrupted movement in the national capital, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Sunday warned that attempts to inconvenience residents or damage public property in the name of demonstrations would not be tolerated, saying no one would be allowed to "hold Delhi hostage".

Gupta made the remarks after visiting Jhandewalan Temple on the first day of Sharadiya Navratri, where she offered prayers to Maa Bhagwati and sought happiness, peace, prosperity and good health for people in Delhi and across the country.

"Everyone has the right to express their views in a democracy, but inconveniencing the public, damaging public property and disrupting the normal order of the city in the name of protest are unacceptable," the Chief Minister said.

Taking aim at those she accused of placing their interests above the country's welfare, Gupta prayed that Maa Bhagwati would grant wisdom to people who, she said, were troubled by the nation's progress.

"The people of Delhi have nothing to do with those who cannot think about the country, work towards its interests or take pride in its progress," she said.

The Chief Minister said the Delhi government was committed to ensuring public safety, convenience and the smooth functioning of the city. She added that the government would take steps to prevent residents from facing unnecessary inconvenience.

"Attempts to hold the city hostage or damage public property will not be tolerated," Gupta said, reiterating that maintaining order and protecting the interests of Delhi residents remained the government's priorities.

Her remarks came amid the political debate over protests and their impact on public life in the capital.

Extending her Navratri greetings, Gupta said the festival conveyed the message of faith, devotion, strength and righteousness. She said the nine forms of Goddess Durga inspired people to practise courage, self-restraint, compassion and dharma.

The Chief Minister also expressed hope that "the festival would bring positivity and prosperity to every household and that Delhi and the country would continue to progress with the blessings of Maa Bhagwati."

Govt approves Rs 9.75 cr aid for 123 sportspersons

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11

The Delhi government has approved Rs 9.75 crore in financial assistance for 123 sportspersons, including 89 elite athletes and 34 school-level players, under the Mukhyamantri Khel Prothsahan Yojana (MMKPY), Education Minister Ashish Sood said on Sunday.

Of the total amount, Rs 5.85 crore, or 60 per cent, will be transferred directly to the verified bank accounts of beneficiaries in the first phase. The remaining Rs 3.90 crore will be released after verification of utilisation certificates and supporting vouchers, according to the government.

Elite sportspersons will be eligible for financial assistance of up to Rs 20 lakh each to meet expenses related to specialised coaching, sports equipment, nutrition and advanced training. The assistance is intended to support athletes competing at higher levels and help them prepare for national and international events.

The scheme has also been expanded to include additional sporting disciplines. At the elite level, Wushu, roller skating, kabaddi, handball and basketball have been included, while school-level support will cover Wushu, Mallakhamb, Yogasana and roller skating. The beneficiaries were recommended by a Committee of Experts, the government said. "Our vision for Delhi's education system extends beyond traditional classrooms. Sports and physical education are fundamental pillars in shaping resilient, confident youth. Through the Mukhyamantri Khel Prothsahan Yojana, we are ensuring that financial constraints never stand in the way of our young athletes' dreams," Sood said. He added that the expansion of support to school-level and elite athletes would help create a pathway for Delhi's sporting talent to compete at national and international levels.

"Education and sports go hand in hand in building strong, disciplined citizens. Through this scheme, we are ensuring our school students and elite athletes receive world-class training without any financial worries," the minister said.

DURGA SCHEME to give 1,300 e-autos to women, transgenders

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11

Delhi government will distribute 1,300 pink electric autos to women and transgenders under its DURGA (Driving, Upliftment and Rozgar for Women and Transgender) E-Auto Scheme , Transport Minister Pankaj Singh said on Sunday. In the first phase, 1,300 pink electric autos will be allotted, of which 1,170 will be reserved for women and 130 for transgender beneficiaries.

"The objective goes beyond allocation of electric vehicles. It is about creating opportunities for women and transgender persons to build independent livelihoods, participate more actively in the transport sector and become self-reliant," Singh said.

By promoting electric autos operated by these beneficiaries, we also aim to strengthen public confidence, encourage cleaner mobility and make last-mile transportation more accessible and inclusive," he added. Under the first phase, a maximum of 90 electric autos for women and up to 10 for transgender beneficiaries will be allocated in each revenue district in accordance with prescribed quotas and eligibility conditions.

"The scheme will have a transparent and structured allocation process through a dedicated digital portal developed by the National Informatics Centre. Applications will be scrutinised by district-level committees chaired by respective District Magistrates," Singh further said. Verification will be undertaken on a weekly basis and where eligible applications exceed the available district quota, an online draw of lots will be conducted.

MCD acts against 1,046 properties after collapse

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11



The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has taken action against 1,046 properties over illegal construction and unsafe buildings between September 6 and October 10, averaging around 30 properties a day, the Chief Minister's Office (CMO) said on Sunday.

The drive was intensified following the collapse of a multi-storey building in southeast Delhi's Satya Niketan on September 6, which claimed seven lives, the CMO said. On the directions of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the MCD has stepped up action against illegal constructions and unsafe buildings across its 12 zones, according to an official statement.

Of the 1,046 properties against which action was taken, the highest number was recorded in the Rohini zone at 158, followed by South (121), Shahdara North (115), West, City-Sadar Paharganj and Shahdara South (87 each), Karol Bagh (85), Central (75), Civil Lines (63), Narela (62), Keshavpuram (61) and Najafgarh (45).

During the period, 282 properties were sealed, while 47 dangerous buildings were demolished, the statement said.

Of the sealed properties, 87 were in the City-SP zone, 41 in Shahdara North and South, 27 in Shahdara South and 20 in Keshavpuram, while 18 were in the Central zone, among others. The highest number of demolitions was recorded in Karol Bagh at 13, followed by West, Civil Lines and City-Sadar Paharganj, with eight each. One or two dangerous buildings were demolished in several other zones, while no demolitions were recorded in Shahdara North and Central, the CMO said.

Following the collapse of a building in Seemapuri earlier this week, which claimed five lives, authorities demolished an unsafe building in the area. The Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) also issued notices to three other houses, the statement said. Gupta said the campaign against illegal construction and dangerous buildings would continue across all zones of Delhi and would not be restricted to any particular locality. The government's objective was to ensure compliance with building regulations and reduce the risk of accidents, she said.



PUBLIC TRAFFIC ADVISORY

Bloomberg New Economy Forum (BNEF), New Delhi

13th October 2026, FROM 0700 TO 1300 HRS

DELHI POLICE
SHANTI SEWA NYAYA

VENUE: Hotel Taj Palace, Sardar Patel Marg

DIVERSIONS: 09 Points

SUMMIT DATES: 13 – 15 October, 2026

ROADS REGULATED: 13+ roads





01 AFFECTED ROADS

• Sardar Patel Marg • Mother Teresa Crescent • Africa Avenue Road (From Ring Road to R/A Yashwant Place) • Satya Marg • Niti Marg (From Satya Marg to Pancsheel Marg) • Panchsheel Marg (From Sardar Patel Marg to R/A Shanti Path) • Brigadier Hoshiar Singh Marg • Vinay Marg (R/A Yashwant Place to Panchsheel Marg) • Shanti Path (From Ring Road to Pancsheel Marg) • Nyay Marg (From Satya Marg to Pancsheel Marg) • Chandara Gupta Marg • San Martin Marg • Manas Marg • Army Battle Honours Mess Road • Abai Marg

02 ALL DIVERSION POINTS (01–09)

S.No.	DIVERSION POINT	NOT ALLOWED	DIVERTED VIA / ROUTE
01	Dhuala Kuan Flyover (DKFO)	Sardar Patel Marg	For East/South Delhi-Ring Road (MGM) For New Delhi/CP/Central/North/West Delhi - Vande Matram
02	Vande Matram Marg – Simon Bolivar Marg Crossing	Simon Bolivar Marg	For East/South Delhi - Vande Matram Marg - DKFO - Ring Road (MGM) For New Delhi/CP - Vande Matram Marg - Turn Right Shankar Road For Central/North - Vande Matram Marg Towards Jhandewala For West Delhi (i) - Vande Matram Marg - Turn Left Shankar Road (ii)- Vande Matram Marg Towards DKFO Turn Right Ring Road (MGM)
03	R/A Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital (RML)	Mother Teresa Crescent	For New Delhi/Central/North/East - Baba Kharak Singh Marg For South Delhi - Sheikh Mujibur Rahman Marg - Shankar Road - Vande Matram Marg For West - Sheikh Mujibur Rahman Marg - Shankar Road
04	Sardar Patel Marg – Mother Teresa Crescent Crossing	Sardar Patel Marg	For South Delhi - Mother Teresa Crescent - R/A Teen Murti - Teen Murti Marg - Safdarjung Road For East - Mother Teresa Crescent - R/A Teen Murti - Teen Murti Marg - Akbar Road For West/Central/North - Mother Teresa Crescent - R/A RML
05	R/A Teen Murti	Towards Mother Teresa Crescent	For West/Central/North Delhi - Teen Murti Marg - Akbar Road - Janpath
06	R/A Panchsheel Marg – Shanti Path	Towards Panchsheel Marg	For West/East/South Delhi - Panchsheel Marg - Mushtafa Kemal Attaturk Marg - APJ Abdul Kalam Road - Tuglaq Road or Aurobindo Marg For Central/North Delhi - Panchsheel Marg - Mushtafa Kemal Attaturk Marg - APJ Abdul Kalam Road - Tuglaq Road
07	Ring Road - Africa Avenue Crossing	Towards Africa Avenue	For Central/West/North Delhi - Ring Road Towards Dhaula Kuan For New Delhi/East Delhi - Ring Road towards AIIMS
08	Ring Road - Moti Bagh Crossing	Shanti Path	For Central/West/North Delhi - Ring Road Towards Dhaula Kuan For New Delhi/East Delhi - Ring Road towards AIIMS
09	Ring Road – San Martin Marg Crossing	San Martin Marg	For Central/West/North Delhi - Ring Road Towards Dhaula Kuan For New Delhi/East Delhi - Ring Road towards AIIMS

03 ALTERNATE ROUTES — RAILWAY STATIONS & AIRPORT

NEW DELHI/OLD DELHI RAILWAY STATIONS
Route A: Dhaula Kuan Flyover - Vande Matram Marg
Route B: AIIMS Flyover - Aurobindo Marg Towards Aurobindo Chowk

FROM NEW DELHI/CENTRAL/NORTH DELHI
Route - A - T3: Ring Road - AIIMS Chowk - Moti Bagh Chowk - RTR Marg - under Shankar Vihar Flyover - Sanjay T-Point - Service Road - NH-48 - under Mahipalpur Flyover Rangpuri - T-3 Road
Route - B - Vande Matram Marg - Dhaula Kuan Flyover - Gurugram Road NH-48 - under Mahipalpur Flyover Rangpuri - T-3 Road

04 TRANSPORT SERVICES

BUS — Route diversions possible during VVIP movements.

METRO — Fully operational at all stations — no disruption.

TAXI/AUTO — No roadside parking except designated areas; diversions possible.

05 IMPORTANT INSTRUCTIONS & PUBLIC ADVISORY

PRIORITY CORRIDORS & EXEMPTIONS
- Emergency & Medical Vehicles: Priority, obstruction-free passage maintained 24/7 across Delhi.
- Essential Services & Utilities: Uninterrupted access granted for essential supplies and utility operations in all zones.

TRAFFIC RULES & PARKING
- Designated Parking: Park only in authorized areas and avoid roadside parking.
- Road Discipline: Follow the instructions of deployed traffic personnel and obey all traffic rules patiently.

TRAVEL PLANNING & PUBLIC MOBILITY
- Transit Hubs: Allow extra travel time when heading to Airports, Railway Stations, and ISBTs.
- Public Transport & Routes: Opt for public transport and follow designated alternative routes and diversion points.
- Commercial Traffic: Non-destined commercial vehicles are prohibited from entering Delhi.

PUBLIC SAFETY & UPDATES
- Security Vigilance: Report any unidentified objects or suspicious activity to the nearest police officer immediately.
- Real-Time Information: Stay updated via official Delhi Police social media channels and traffic portals.
- Public cooperation is solicited to ensure smooth transit and safety for all.

PLAN AHEAD. TRAVEL SMART.

For the complete point-wise diversion list and live updates during the Bloomberg Summit 2026 advisory window, follow Delhi Traffic Police online.

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DP/9919/2026

General public and motorists may remain updated through Delhi Traffic Police Website https://traffic.delhipolice.gov.in, Facebook page https://www.facebook.com/dtptraffic, X handle https://X@dtptraffic, Instagram page https://www.instagram.com/dtptraffic

BE A TRAFFIC PRAHARI | DOWNLOAD APP FROM Google play or App Store | 24 HRS. TRAFFIC HELPLINE: 011-25844444/1095 | TRAFFIC WHATSAPP HELPLINE 8750871493 | TO SHARE ANTI TERRORIST ACTIVITIES, CALL 14547 | FOR IMMEDIATE POLICE HELP CALL 112

J'khand: Two die following gas exposure at ESL Steel plant

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Ranchi, October 11

Two persons died following gas exposure at ESL Steel plant in Jharkhand's Bokaro district on Sunday, prompting the local administration to order a probe into the accident, an official said.

The accident occurred at ESL Steel Limited, Bokaro, a subsidiary of Vedanta Iron & Steel Limited (VISL).

"Two persons died in a mishap at ESL Steel Ltd Bokaro plant, and the district administration has ordered a probe into it," the official said.

"Chas Sub-Divisional Magistrate Pranjal Danda asked Executive Magistrate Jaya Kumari and Factory Inspector Shivanand Laguri to visit the site and submit a detailed report to the district administration within 72 hours," Bokaro Deputy Commissioner Ajay Nath Jha said. Labour Superintendent Ranjit Kumar will ensure that adequate compensation is paid to the next of kin of the deceased as per law, Jha said.

The company, however, did not provide the details of the accident, saying it will conduct an independent investigation and take an appropriate step based on the findings. "An unfortunate incident involving gas exposure occurred at the plant in which an executive of the company and a business partner engineer lost their lives," an ESL spokesperson said.

CJP TELEGRAPHED ITS OCTOBER 10 PROTEST IN ADVANCE

The art of deflection: How AISA's flash protests outsmarted capital's lockdown

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, October 11



The autumn air in the capital was thick with tension, tear gas, and the relentless hum of police sirens.

For days, the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) and student federations had vowed to make their voices heard at Jantar Mantar, demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

But what unfolded on the streets of New Delhi transcended a standard political protest morphing instead into a theatre of strategy, mistaken identities, and heavy-handed state clampdowns.

Unlike the CJP, which had telegraphed its October 10 protest weeks in advance giving the administration ample time to lock down central Delhi AISA National president Neha Bora played a different game. On Saturday, October 10, after police blockaded Dilli Haat, Bora declared it would become their new Jantar Mantar before being detained near Jor Bagh.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **On Saturday, after police blockaded Dilli Haat, Bora declared it would become their new Jantar Mantar before being detained near Jor Bagh**
- **While the police swarmed her lookalike, Bora herself was sprinting through the Connaught Place and Vijay Chowk areas, attempting to pierce security cordon and reach the protest site**

On Sunday, the playbook shifted entirely. Declaring a flash protest at the RK Ashram Marg metro station just one hour before it was slated to begin at 2:30 pm, Bora executed a brilliant tactical deflection.

As heavy police contingents and media cameras converged on RK Ashram following reports of her presence, chaos ensued. A person resembling Bora complete with a pink chunni on her face and glasses was spotted and chased by police and reporters, creating a massive decoy frenzy.

Yet, the spectacle was a masterstroke of misdirection. While the police swarmed her lookalike, Bora herself was sprinting through the Connaught Place and Vijay Chowk areas, attempting to pierce the security cordon and reach the protest site. Though she later clarified that the tale of the two Nehas was a sheer coincidence rather than a choreographed decoy, the confusion paralysed police coordination.

The capital's streets, however, offered little room for error. Over 100 protesters from the AISA, SFI, and KYS were swiftly rounded up. SFI activists alleged that hundreds had been dragged into buses and hauled off to Surajmal Stadium in Nangloi. Visuals from Connaught Place's Inner Circle showed demonstrators chanting slogans like "Gyanesh Kumar isteefa do" before being physically subdued, dragged across asphalt, and forced into waiting transport.

The crackdown extended beyond the streets and into the digital sphere. An AISA member's Instagram video exposing police violence was abruptly blocked in India under Section 79(3)(b) of the IT Act, drawing sharp rebukes from activists who argued that democratic expression was being systematically dismantled under the guise of law enforcement.

The media itself became a target of the sweeping security measures. Prominent journalists, including Pragya Mishra of Ulta Chashma, found themselves detained alongside student demonstrators. Mishra recounted harrowing scenes of police hostility, noting how security personnel attempted to intimidate reporters, injured a cameraman, and ordered officials to violently lift and drag detainees into custody.

For her part, Neha Bora after dodging the initial dragnet and making her presence felt was ultimately detained near Vijay Chowk. Describing her harrowing experience inside a detention bus, she painted a grim picture of cells lined with iron grills, locked gates, and alleged physical abuse directed at protesters.

India rejects UN human rights agency's remarks on Delhi protests

Over 7,000 demonstrators were detained in New Delhi on Saturday

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11

AN IDENTICAL STATEMENT WAS ISSUED LAST NIGHT BY PERMANENT MISSION OF INDIA AT UN IN GENEVA

India on Sunday trashed the UN human rights agency's remarks voicing concerns over detention of thousands of protesters in Delhi, describing them as "unwarranted" and an "unacceptable interference" in the country's internal affairs.

The Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) in Geneva on Saturday called on the authorities to ensure that the right to peaceful assembly is fully respected and fulfilled.

"The OHCHR's concerns are therefore unwarranted and constitute an unacceptable interference in the internal affairs of India," the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said.

An identical statement was issued last night by Permanent Mission of India at UN in Geneva.

Over 7,000 demonstrators were detained in New Delhi on Saturday as authorities cordoned off the capital to thwart a protest calling for the chief election commissioner's resignation.

"We also note that the OHCHR has an approach of extreme selectivity when it comes to public positions. Violent responses to protests in our neighbourhood have gone uncommented, as indeed have law enforcement actions in its own vicinity," the MEA said.

"Such double standards only erode the credibility of its standing and contribute to the loss of faith in multilateralism," it added.

The MEA said India is the "world's largest democracy, where the right to peaceful assembly is guaranteed by our Constitution and safeguarded by robust institutions, an independent judiciary and a free media".

"As in every democracy, Indian citizens exercise this right subject to the maintenance of public order and safety.

"Our law enforcement authorities act strictly in accordance with the law, and our courts remain available to all for the redressal of any grievances," the MEA said in a statement.

From page 1

SC order fails

plant documents or other material to be used later against them as evidence.

Several journalists, who were covering the protests were also detained by police despite displaying press identification cards, according to visuals emerging on social media. They were seen showing press cards to officials as they were taken away.

Police detained three Indian Express Hindi journalists at Connaught Place. The journalists, Shashwat, Siya and Vijay, displayed their valid press cards but were taken into detention and forced into buses by police personnel, the newspaper said. They were released at Chhatrasal Stadium around 45 minutes later. The police did not cite any specific legal provision or reason for detaining the journalists. Another journalist of The Hindu, despite displaying her identity card, was also being detained but she was allowed to go before the bus moved.

A bus packed with the detainees at Connaught Place included two journalists and at least two protesters who were bruised and bleeding.

The journalists - including one from a national daily, from digital news platforms and camera persons - were detained from outside the Press Club of India on Raisina Road, Connaught Place and RK Ashram Marg. More than 70 people were held outside the Press Club of India. At Raisina Road, NSUI members staged a protest after the CJP concluded their press conference.

Overall, about 100 protesters were packed into two buses and removed from the area. A man was pulled out of a burger joint on suspicion of being a protester. A video of the incident showed him telling the cops that he was simply standing at the spot and that he would not go with the team. He was later allowed to go. There were also reports and visuals regarding right-wing activists beating up protesters, with the police remaining a mute spectator.

The police action against protesters came despite the top court's order during a special sitting earlier in the day that peaceful, unarmed protesters cannot be detained except in accordance with the "procedure established by law". The court also said the police cannot detain such peaceful protesters beyond the area covered by a prohibitory order under Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS).

Besides, AISA president Neha Bora and CPI(M) leader John Brittas were detained at Connaught Place. Brittas suffered injuries after he was dragged by the security personnel.

On Saturday, about 40,000 security personnel turned Delhi into a fortress to foil a planned protest, launching an unprecedented clampdown that saw the detention of 7,000 people, including four former chief ministers.

Members of several student organisations, including the Students' Federation of India (SFI), All India Students' Association (AISA) and Krantikari Yuva Sangathan (KYS), along with CJP supporters, were detained while trying to march towards Jantar Mantar from different parts of the capital, mainly Connaught Place.

The SFI organised a women's march around 6.30 pm, after which it alleged that several women protesters were detained from Connaught Place. It claimed that female protesters were detained by male police personnel and alleged that their detention -- after 6 pm -- was illegal.

Visuals circulating on social media showed protesters marching through Connaught Place's Inner Circle, raising slogans demanding the resignation of CEC Kumar.

Security personnel were seen moving towards protesters to disperse them. Several demonstrators resisted as police personnel held them by their arms and pulled them towards waiting buses. Some protesters were seen being dragged along the road, while others continued raising slogans as they were taken into custody.

The day witnessed a series of flash protests, with different groups assembling at various locations at different times to try to reach Jantar Mantar. Connaught Place and RK Ashram Marg were among the main points where demonstrations and detentions took place.

CPI (M) Rajya Sabha MP John Brittas was among those detained, police sources said. The SFI alleged that its leaders were assaulted inside cage-like police vans.The detentions continued into the evening, with student organisations reporting fresh pick-ups and raising concerns over the treatment of those in custody.

Later, the CPI (M) shared a video of John Brittas, Rajya Sabha MP, appearing distressed and being helped out of a vehicle.

In a post on X, the CPI(M) said Brittas was "brutally attacked" by Delhi Police. "DELHI POLICE HAS CROSSED ALL LIMITS!" the party wrote in its post.

Brittas said he was detained after reaching Connaught Place to support SFI activists who were being taken into custody. He said he was speaking to the media when police personnel forced him into a bus.

According to Brittas, several Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) personnel pinned him and another person down against a seat inside the vehicle. He said the personnel continued to restrain him despite his repeatedly identifying himself as a Member of Parliament.

The MP further said he was subsequently pushed out of the vehicle and left by the roadside.

CJI declines

official reaction from the Opposition after the CJI declined the meeting, leaving the status of the planned march unclear.

The Congress had said INDIA bloc leaders, MPs, workers, young people and civil society groups would assemble at the Connaught Place-Barakhamba Road junction at 1.30 pm before marching towards the Supreme Court. It was not immediately clear whether the programme would proceed as announced following the CJI's response.

In a post on X on Sunday, Gandhi had appealed to citizens across political and social divides to join the proposed march, describing it as a collective effort to defend democracy and the Constitution.

"Tomorrow, we will march to the Supreme Court as Indians, united beyond party, gender, caste, community and state. Youth, all opposition parties, civil society groups, all those who believe in democracy and stand by the Constitution of India, will walk with us," he said.

Gandhi also criticised the police action against protesters at Jantar Mantar on Saturday, alleging that young demonstrators had been beaten by police personnel and BJP workers despite gathering peacefully.

"Yesterday, the nation's young came out in Delhi to peacefully protest. They came with love in their hearts, not hatred or anger. They were beaten, both by cops and BJP goons. This is not the India we want," he wrote.

Kharge, speaking in Bengaluru earlier on Sunday, confirmed that he and Gandhi had written separately to the CJI seeking an opportunity to present their concerns and request his intervention.

"We have sought a time between 4 and 5 pm. We will also apprise him, as we cannot demand. Only with folded hands, we can request him," Kharge said.

He accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah of creating political turmoil and described the situation as an "undeclared emergency". Kharge also alleged that the heavy security deployment and detentions during Saturday's protests reflected the government's apprehension about the youth-led agitation.

The latest developments follow a series of Opposition demonstrations against Kumar and alleged electoral irregularities. On Friday, INDIA bloc leaders marched from Parliament to Vijay Chowk and later submitted a memorandum to President Droupadi Murmu, demanding the CEC's resignation and raising concerns over the electoral process.The Opposition has also questioned the Election Commission's handling of electoral rolls, particularly the SIR exercise, and called for a return to paper ballots. Whether the planned march to the Supreme Court will go ahead remains unclear following the CJI's decision not to agree to the requested meeting.

Saudi Airport

On Sunday, the Indian Embassy in Riyadh said that one Indian national injured in the Riyadh attack has "unfortunately lost his life today."

"We convey our heartfelt condolences to the family of the deceased. We are in touch with the family and will provide all support for ensuring the early repatriation of mortal remains," it said in a social media post.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar expressed grief over the death of the Indian national in the attack.

"Deeply grieved at the loss of life of an Indian national in the Riyadh attack. My heartfelt condolences to the bereaved family. The Embassy will extend all possible assistance," Jaishankar said in a post on X.

In another post, the embassy said it has been following up on the "dastardly attack" on Riyadh airport and was in touch with the local authorities to enquire about the well-being of the injured Indian nationals.

"It is learnt that 11 Indians are among those injured in the attack. Embassy has been in touch with local authorities to enquire about their well-being. Our officials have also reached out to the hospital authorities," the embassy said.

The Indian Embassy also said Akasa Air has extended the suspension of all flights to and from Riyadh till October 13.

Saudi authorities blamed Iran-backed Houthi militants for the attack, which was reported to be the deadliest in a Gulf Arab country since the Iran war began. The victims included Saudi nationals and citizens of Bangladesh, the United States, Jordan, Palestine, Syria, Sudan and Egypt.The latest strike followed two earlier attacks on the airport that killed four people and damaged a Saudi commercial aircraft.

Trump

Moscow did not immediately comment on the announcement, and the White House did not clarify the president's post.

Zelenskyy, in an interview aired Sunday, said Ukraine was ready to stop striking Russian refineries if Moscow halted attacks on Ukraine's energy system, and asked Trump to press the Kremlin to agree.

"We are asking President Trump, (to) give them (a) signal, not (to) attack energy infrastructure of Ukraine," he told ABC's "This Week."

Trump said Saturday it was time for Ukraine to get a new president, suggesting Zelenskyy has not done enough to end the war and blaming him for high diesel prices in the US

Zelenskyy said in response to Trump's comments that Ukraine could hold elections if Russia agreed to a 60-day ceasefire. "Give us two months, 60 days off. Total ceasefire, 60 days, and we will organise elections," he said, adding that Ukraine would be ready to accept whatever choice its people made.

Manipur

Kamjong district on Friday night. The killing triggered an exchange of fire between Kuki and Naga armed groups that continued until Saturday morning, leaving a 42-year-old man dead and 10 houses burnt. Prohibitory orders have been imposed under Section 162 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita. In Kangpokpi district, suspected militants allegedly killed two Naga village guards, M Daimai and R Gangmei, and another person, Ringkangmai, in attacks on Tapon and Makui villages on Saturday. A Naga civil society organisation also alleged that a 52-year-old villager, Ajinbou R, was beheaded and demanded the return of his head for a dignified burial.

Two more people, Ngachanso Ningshen, 35, and Leishishan Leishadang, 48, were killed when suspected militants opened fire in Ningchou village in Kamjong district, near the Myanmar border. In Ukhrul, 40-year-old Sandeep Rai was shot dead inside his car near Chepu Yaolen village.

Additional forces have been deployed in Kangpokpi and Kamjong to prevent further violence.

More than 40 people have been killed and dozens of houses burnt in Kuki-Naga clashes since February. Earlier ethnic violence between Meiteis and Kukis killed over 300 people, left 49 missing and displaced thousands.

PM

development, serving its people remains steadfast," Modi said. Referring to Vijay, whose Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) formed its first government after winning the April Assembly elections, he added that the two leaders were working together to advance the state's progress.

Earlier, Modi and Vijay jointly flagged off services on the Ponamallee-Vadapalani stretch of Chennai Metro Phase 2. The network, developed as a joint venture between the Centre and the Tamil Nadu government, marks a significant expansion of public transport in the state. The two leaders also jointly inaugurated the infrastructure projects later in the day.

Modi, who recently completed 25 years as the head of a government, said the experience had strengthened his faith in the people and cooperative federalism. He took oath as Gujarat chief minister in October 2001 before becoming prime minister in 2014.

Recalling his interactions with former Tamil Nadu chief ministers M Karunanidhi and J Jayalalithaa during his tenure in Gujarat, he also referred to his subsequent dealings with O Panneerselvam, Edappadi K Palaniswami and M K Stalin as prime minister.

The prime minister also spoke about India's manufacturing and export growth over the past 12 years. He said electronics exports had risen 11-fold since 2014, while defence exports had increased 50-fold. Engineering exports had also reached record levels, creating employment opportunities for young people, including in Tamil Nadu.

On port infrastructure, Modi said an investment of around Rs 17,000 crore was being made to develop V O Chidambaranar Port in Thoothukudi into a major container and green energy hub. Once completed, the facility will be able to accommodate ultra-large container vessels and support the state's industrial and transport sectors.Modi said metro services, which operated in five Indian cities in 2014, were now available in 25 cities. He said the newly launched projects would improve daily travel, strengthen trade and industry, and generate jobs.

Following the inaugurations, Modi travelled on the Chennai Metro between Porur Bypass and Poonamallee Bypass stations and back, accompanied by Vijay and senior officials.

URGE PARTIES TO UNITE AHEAD OF INDIA BLOC MARCH

CJP leaders vow to protest till Gyanesh Kumar resigns

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11



CJP leaders during a press conference, in New Delhi, Sunday PTI

Top CJP leaders on Sunday vowed to expand their protests nationwide on the SIR issue after they were released from preventive custody though 100 more people were detained as police maintained the security chokehold on the Capital.

In a special sitting, the Supreme Court directed that people gathering peacefully should not be illegally detained and asked authorities to ensure that Delhi Metro functions normally, and that there is no disruption to internet services, subject to law and order conditions.

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, who were set free on a condition that they would not "breach peace" for a year, claimed that their detention was illegal and their protest would continue till Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar resigns.

"We are not dreaded criminals; we are not going to Narendra Modi or Amit Shah's house to protest. Protest at designated protest spot is not disturbing peace," Ranka said at a press conference later.

Ranka said the protest will not stop till Gyanesh Kumar resigns.

CJP and Opposition leaders were among 7,000 protesters detained at multiple locations on Saturday as authorities thwarted their attempt to reach Jantar Mantar for a planned demonstration against CEC Kumar with an unprecedented security clampdown in Delhi. All these detainees have been released.

An apex court bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana issued a notice to the Centre while hearing a plea seeking contempt proceedings for alleged violation of the court's direction to ensure that there is no "complete prohibition" on metro and train services in Delhi due to the CJP protest.

The bench asked Solicitor General Tushar Mehta to ensure that Delhi Metro functions as per its normal schedule, and that there is no disruption to internet services, subject to law and order conditions. The apex court also asked Mehta to ensure that lawyers, journalists and others shall not be impeded in discharging their professional duties.

CJP's Saurav Das alleged that the Modi government has created an "emergency-like situation" and turned the state against its own citizens.

Ranka alleged that he, Das and Abhijeet Dipke had been "kidnapped" from an aircraft.

Das said the police had illegally detained them without any formal notice and alleged that their phones were seized and they were not allowed to contact a lawyer.

Ranka and Das claimed that their mobile phones may have been hacked or cloned during their 24-hour detention by the Delhi Police.

KEY POINTS

- 'We are not dreaded criminals; we are not going to Narendra Modi or Amit Shah's house to protest'
- Ranka and Das claimed that their mobile phones may have been hacked or cloned during their detention

Restores people's faith in justice system: Sibal

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11

Rajya Sabha MP and senior advocate Kapil Sibal on Sunday welcomed the Supreme Court's directions on protests in Delhi, saying the order restored the faith of people and professionals in the country's justice system.

"We are deeply grateful to the Supreme Court of India for passing an order that restores the faith of the Indian people, as well as the faith of professionals, in the justice system of this country," Sibal said.

The top court on Sunday directed that people gathering peacefully should not be illegally detained and asked the Centre to ensure that Delhi Metro services function as per their normal schedule and internet services remain uninterrupted, subject to law and order conditions.

A bench of Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana also directed that lawyers, journalists and others should not be impeded from discharging their professional duties.

From raising students' concerns, CJP shifted to electoral issues, claims BJP

Prasad alleges that CJP doing 'shadow-boxing' for Aam Aadmi Party

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11

The BJP on Sunday took on the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP), saying the group, which cropped up just months ago and led an agitation over the alleged NEET paper leak and primarily students' concerns, has "suddenly" shifted its focus to an issue related to electoral politics.

"Perhaps you wouldn't see such a fast mutation (change) even in radioactive decay," BJP Rajya Sabha MP Sudhanshu Trivedi jibed, while replying to media queries during a press conference at the BJP headquarters here.

On Saturday, senior BJP leader Ravi Shakar Prasad had alleged that CJP is doing "shadow-boxing" for the Aam Aadmi Party.

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) leaders Abhijeet Dipke, Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, who were set free on a condition that they would not "breach peace" for a year, claimed their detention was illegal and the protest would continue till Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar resigns.

Asked about the CJP leaders vowing to continue their protest, Trivedi said, "Look, everyone has the right to protest, but how much it is accepted thereafter is a different matter altogether."

"Another thing has also become clear; what was a students' movement over the examination system, just two months ago, has suddenly turned into agitation over electoral issues," he said in a guarded response.

Parl panel indicts NTA, hope 'arrogant' govt takes it seriously: Cong

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11

The Congress on Sunday said a Parliamentary standing committee report has catalogued the "grave incompetence and malpractice" in the NTA and the Ministry of Education, and hoped that the Modi govt "sheds its arrogance for the limited time it has remaining" and takes the report seriously.

The Congress also said the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education's report, titled "Reforms and Strengthening of the National Testing Agency (NTA)", has highlighted that the Ministry of Education made the "blatantly false" claim to the panel "that no paper leak" occurred in an exam conducted by the National Testing Agency (NTA) since its formation in 2017.

In a statement, Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh said the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education under the chairmanship of Rajya Sabha MP Mukul Wasnik "catalogues the grave incompetence and malpractice in the NTA and the Ministry of Education".

Sharing the statement on X, Ramesh said, "GyaneshGate is dominating the news now but three months ago it was NTAgate that had launched the youth protest movement. Here is our statement on the NTA based on the report of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education that has just been submitted to the Chairman, Rajya Sabha."

Ramesh said the Ministry of Education made the "blatantly false and audacious claim" to the Parliamentary committee "that no paper leak has occurred in an exam conducted by the NTA since its formation in 2017 till 2025."

DELHI POLICE
SHANTI SEWA NYAYA

TRAFFIC POLICE DELHI

TRAFFIC ADVISORY

12 OCT 2026

In view of the law and order situation, traffic may be impacted at some stretches in Delhi on 12.10.2026 during the day.

Diversions

Subject to the ground conditions, there might be dynamic route diversions for managing the traffic. As such traffic might get impacted at following major junctions and stretches on 12.10.2026.

- Round About Panchkuian
- Round About Mandi House
- Dr Dinesh Nandini Dalmia Chowk (W-Point)
- Ram Charan Aggarwal Chowk (A-Point)
- Minto Road/Deen Dayal Upadhyay Marg
- Guru Nanak Chowk
- Chemsford Road – Outer Circle Connaught Place T-Point
- Bharion Road- MGM (Ring Road) T-Point
- Lodhi Road Flyover
- Round About Neela Gumbad
- Sardar Patel Marg- Panchsheel Marg Crossing
- Under Bhikaji Kama Place
- Under Moti Bagh Flyover
- Ring Road-San Martin Marg T-Point
- Round About Ashoka Road – Jantar Mantar Road
- Round About Rail Bhawan
- Jai Singh Road – Sansad Marg Crossing
- Outer Circle Connaught Place -Barakhamba Road T-Point
- Round About Patel Chowk
- Jai Singh Road – Ashoka Road T-Point
- Round About RML Hospital
- Outer Circle Connaught Place - Sansad Marg T-Point

Commuters' Advisory & Recommendations

- Plan in Advance: Please keep extra travel time in hand if heading towards railway stations, ISBTs, or the airport via New Delhi and Central Delhi.
- Avoid Non-Essential Travel: Commuters are requested not to undertake non essential travel
- Dynamic Restrictions: Traffic management measures are dynamic and will be relaxed or regulated based on real-time ground assessment.

Stay Updated (Real-Time Information)

For live updates, alternate routes, and continuous traffic alerts, please keep referring to official Delhi Traffic Police platforms:

- Website: traffic.delhipolice.gov.in
- X (Twitter): @dtptraffic
- Instagram: @dtptraffic
- Facebook: @dtptraffic

DP/9921/2026

24 HOURS TRAFFIC HELPLINE: 011-25844444 / 1095

FOR IMMEDIATE POLICE HELP CALL 112



DIP/Shabdarth/Display/109/26-27

ENSURING PSYCHOLOGICAL WELL-BEING OF STUDENTS & FACULTY

Student suicides: 'IITs consider dedicated mental health cadre'

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 11

Indian Institutes of Technology are considering creating a proper cadre of mental health professionals who will be engaged to ensure the psychological well-being of students and faculty, according to IIT Directors.

Several IITs have been at the centre of controversy this year for student suicides on campus due to different reasons. However, Directors of two IITs confirmed that the plan to create the cadre is not a fallout of the recent suicides but has been deliberated upon for at least two years.

While IITs have taken initiatives in the past to address the mental health of students, the death of an IIT Bombay student on September 18, who was found hanging from the ceiling fan in his hostel room on campus, has triggered protests, bringing back the spotlight on student suicides.

The incident came after an IIT Delhi student died by suicide in August, leading to outrage on the campus, and is one of the several such deaths that have occurred across the premier technical institutions of the country in recent years.

The Ministry of Education had informed Parliament earlier this year that all IITs, IIMs, NITs and IIITs have put in place dedicated mental health or counselling centres within their campuses, staffed with full-time or visiting professional counsellors, clinical psychologists, and in some cases, psychiatrists.



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

HIGHLIGHTS

- Several IITs have been at the centre of controversy this year for student suicides on campus due to different reasons
- However, Directors of two IITs confirmed that the plan to create the cadre is not a fallout of the recent suicides
- It has been deliberated upon for at least two years, they said

"Counselling is available to students across all campuses at present. Some IITs have engaged with third-party apps while many have counsellors on campus, but that is not enough for the kind of student strength on campuses and a sustainable and long-term solution is being explored," an IIT Director told PTI.

"Mental health initiatives have been at centre of attention at IITs in previous years, and it has been deliberated upon since at least two years that IITs should have a proper cadre for mental health professionals, which not only provides a support system to the students but to faculty members and any staff member on campus," he added.

At present, there are 23 IITs functioning across the country with the student population ranging from 3,000 to 18,000 on each campus besides faculty members, their families and a broader community living in the premises.

"It has been felt that dedicated posts including counsellors, psychologists and psychiatrists need to be created within the IITs because unless specific posts are created and funding is earmarked, even contractual appointments are not possible.

"The idea is not a fallout of the recent unfortunate episodes. The proposal was also placed before former Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan and IIT Gandhinagar is working on a structure for all IITs which includes sanctioned posts for counsellors, psychologists and psychiatrists", another IIT Director said. According to minutes of the IIT Council meeting held last year, the structure, when prepared, will be in accordance with the Rehabilitation Council of India (RCI) guidelines with adequate promotional avenues and provisions for quality assessment from time to time, so that a sustainable and reliable structure can be built.

BITS Pilani Group Vice Chancellor and former IIT Delhi Director V Ramgopal Rao has been flagging that problems arising at IITs on this front are because of the "one-size-fits-all approach in IITs" where doors are opened for meritorious students from all backgrounds, but teaching-learning methods are not adapted to address the "heterogeneity".

A National Task Force (NTF) appointed by the Supreme Court had flagged in its interim report that the faculty members across IITs felt ill-equipped to address mental health issues, and 90 per cent lacked proper training to support students with such sensitive concerns.

US made no formal F-35 fighter jets offer to India, says IAF chief Singh

In humorous remark, he says they don't even 'let us go near' the one

MPOST BUREAU
Jodhpur, October 11

Indian Air Force Chief Air Chief Marshal A P Singh has said the United States had made no official offer to sell F-35 fifth-generation fighter jets to India, while also clarifying that no final decision has been made on the Russian proposal for Su-57 fighter aircraft.

Singh revealed this while addressing a press conference on the sidelines of the concluding ceremony of the multinational air exercise Tarang Shakti-2026 in Jodhpur on Saturday.

Sitting alongside the commander of the US Air Force's Pacific Air Forces (PACAF), Singh responded to a question about the reported F-35 offer with a humorous remark, saying, "Your people don't even let us go near the aircraft, and you are talking about selling it to us." The IAF chief also addressed the possibility of India acquiring Russia's fifth-generation Su-57 fighter aircraft. He said that it has come to their notice that Russia has made an offer but clarified that "no decision has been made" regarding whether the aircraft needs to be evaluated or not.

"Once the decision is conveyed to us (by the government), we will evaluate how well it (Su-57) meets our requirements," he said.



Chief of the Air Staff Air Chief Marshal AP Singh, US Pacific Air Forces Commander General Kevin Schneider, Air and Space Inspector General, FASF, General Stephane Groen and others during a press conference on the Exercise Tarang Shakti 2026, in Jodhpur, Saturday PTI

THE REMARKS COME AS INDIA CONTINUES TO ASSESS ITS FUTURE COMBAT AIRCRAFT REQUIREMENTS

The remarks come as India continues to assess its future combat aircraft requirements and pursue the development of its own fifth-generation fighter aircraft under its long-term plans to strengthen self-reliance in defence manufacturing.

Tarang Shakti-2026 brought together the Indian Air Force and participating foreign air forces from eight nations, including India, providing a platform for operational cooperation and the exchange of professional experience.

Justice must go beyond judicial orders: Himachal Pradesh CM

ASHWANI SHARMA
Shimla, October 11

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Sunday said justice in a democracy must be guided by fairness, wisdom and an understanding of circumstances, and not remain confined to judicial orders.

Addressing the third convocation of Himachal Pradesh National Law University, Shimla, Sukhu said the law must protect the rights of every citizen and ensure that even the weakest sections of society could access justice.


Former Chief Justice of Jharkhand HC receives an honorary doctorate degree

Referring to court rulings on public employment, he said certain decisions granting financial benefits beyond recruitment rules had placed an additional burden on the state exchequer.

Supreme Court Justice M M Sundresh urged law graduates to prepare for emerging challenges, particularly artificial intelligence, which he said would significantly influence the legal profession.

High Court Chief Justice Gurmeet Singh Sandhawalia conferred degrees upon the graduating students.

Punjab CM highlights govt's welfare schemes

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 11

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann on Sunday said his government had earned people's trust through four-and-a-half years of work, highlighting welfare schemes, employment generation, improved irrigation and free electricity.

Addressing a Lok Milni programme at Mimsa village in Dhuri constituency, Mann said the government was ensuring that public money was spent on development and welfare rather than personal interests.

He said more than 70,000 government jobs had been provided without corruption and over 90 per cent of households were receiving free electricity. He also highlighted daytime power supply for farmers and the expansion of canal irrigation.

According to Mann, the area receiving canal water had increased from 20.89 lakh acres in 2022 to 60.30 lakh acres. He said the government had spent Rs 7,200 crore on expanding irrigation facilities, with canal water reaching 1,587 villages that had not received it earlier.

The chief minister also cited the Mukh Mantri Sehat Yojna, which provides cashless treatment of up to Rs 10 lakh per family, and the Mawan Dheeyan Satkar Yojna, offering monthly financial assistance to eligible women.

Haryana opens state's first Tourist Police Post

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 11

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Sunday inaugurated the state's first Tourist Police Post at Shri Mata Mansa Devi Temple in Panchkula to strengthen security, provide assistance to devotees and improve policing at religious sites.

The facility will function as an integrated assistance and information centre, offering guidance, complaint registration and emergency support to devotees visiting the temple from different states and linguistic backgrounds.

A total of 20 specially trained police personnel have been deployed round the clock. Wearing distinctive uniforms, they have received training in courteous behaviour, communication and soft skills to help devotees identify them easily and seek assistance.

During the inauguration, Saini was briefed on the post's facilities and security arrangements. He said the large number of devotees visiting the temple made it necessary for police personnel to understand their language and needs and provide prompt assistance.

The centre will provide information on darshan queues, VIP arrangements, shoe-deposit facilities, prasad, langar, transport hubs and parking. Visitors will also receive directions to other religious sites, including Shri Kali Mata Temple and Shri Chandi Mata Temple in Kalka.

Security will be monitored through more than 100 CCTV cameras installed across the temple complex, with live surveillance from the post's control room.

India moving rapidly towards developed nation status: Saini

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, October 11

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Sunday said India was moving rapidly towards becoming a developed nation under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership, with the country's global standing improving and its youth getting opportunities to realise their potential.

Saini made the remarks while interacting with media persons after offering prayers at the Mata Mansa Devi Temple on the first day of Ashwin Navratri.

He attributed the country's development to the effective implementation of policies and accused the Congress of failing to advance India during its long tenure in power. He alleged that the Congress and the INDIA bloc were attempting to mislead young people through baseless allegations, adding that people were increasingly aware of the Opposition's approach.

The chief minister said the Haryana government was committed to the welfare of economically weaker sections and balanced development. He maintained that eligible beneficiaries should receive the benefits of government schemes and young people should get equal opportunities based on merit.

Highlighting recruitment reforms, Saini said government jobs in Haryana were being awarded on merit without "kharchi-parchi" (bribes or political recommendations). He alleged that nepotism and corruption had characterised recruitment under previous Congress governments.

On law and order, he said ensuring public safety remained a priority and warned that anyone attempting to intimidate citizens would face action under the law.

At Kanha, MP moves to restore wild buffaloes 'after a century'

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA
Bhopal, October 11

Madhya Pradesh has taken a significant step towards restoring wild buffaloes to their historical habitat, with Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Sunday shifting eight animals to a 17-hectare enclosure at the Supkhar range of Kanha Tiger Reserve after completion of their quarantine period.

The initiative aims to re-establish the species, which disappeared from the state's forests nearly a century ago. The eight buffaloes, brought from Assam's Kaziranga National Park, were initially kept in a specially designed one-hectare enclosure to help them acclimatise to local climatic and environmental conditions.

Describing the occasion as significant, Yadav said the second phase of the reintroduction programme had begun at Supkhar after nearly 100 years. He thanked Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma for facilitating the transfer of the animals from Kaziranga to Madhya Pradesh.



EIGHT ANIMALS SHIFTED TO 17-HECTARE ENCLOSURE; STATE TARGETS 50 BUFFALOES IN THREE YEARS

The animals will be gradually prepared for release into their natural habitat after the monsoon season, he said.

The eight wild buffaloes, comprising six females and two males, were brought to Kanha in two batches. The first batch of three females and one male arrived on April 28, 2026, while the second batch, also comprising three females and one male, reached the reserve on May 9.

After being kept in quarantine to facilitate their adaptation to the local environment, all eight animals were shifted to the larger enclosure on Sunday.

The Forest department has set a target of reintroducing 50 wild buffaloes in the Supkhar area over the next three years. The location was selected based on evidence of the species' historical presence in the region. Yadav said the state government was working to restore wildlife species that had disappeared from their former habitats and strengthen ecological balance.

The programme was attended by Principal Secretary, Forest department, Raghwendra Kumar Singh and Principal Chief Conservator of Forest (Wildlife) Samita Rajora.

Guwahati: NCB seizes meth worth Rs 43 cr, arrests two

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Guwahati, October 11

The Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) has seized 53.937 kg of methamphetamine tablets worth around Rs 43 crore in the illegal market and arrested two persons in Guwahati.

The seizure was made from two trucks on October 6. The accused, residents of Manipur's Bishnupur district, were allegedly transporting the consignment from Myanmar, the NCB said.

The agency is investigating the alleged international suppliers, local buyers and financiers involved in the racket.

During a special drive, the NCB's Guwahati unit also arrested six absconders wanted in cases under the NDPS Act. They belonged to Assam, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, Manipur and Tripura. Six other accused were arrested in Manipur.

'Toxic' groundwater in Nashik raises alarm ahead of Kumbh Mela

Groundwater near Kumbh Mela site shows high levels of cancer-linked toxin, claims SANDRP

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 11

Laboratory testing of groundwater at Ambad in Maharashtra's Nashik shows acute toxic contamination, with levels of cancer-linked hexavalent chromium 1,000 times higher than safety limits, according to the South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People.

The contaminated water has caused skin and other health-related issues among residents and is also entering the Godavari River through local drains, it said.

The informal network works on issues related to rivers, communities and large-scale water infrastructure like dams.

The affected river stretch includes ghats where Kumbh Mela will soon be organised, posing a potential health risk to millions of pilgrims who will visit the city, a statement by the South Asia Network on Dams, Rivers and People (SANDRP) released on October 8 said.

It added: "The analysis reveals hexavalent chromium levels of 50.3 mg/L in the total chromium of 50.5 mg/L: surpassing the Bureau of Indian Standards drinking water allowable limit of 0.05 mg/L by over 1,000 times."

KEY POINTS

- The contaminated water has caused skin and other health-related issues among residents and is also entering the Godavari River through local drains, it said
- The affected river stretch includes ghats where Kumbh Mela will soon be organised, posing a potential health risk to millions of pilgrims, SANDRP said
- The informal network works on issues related to rivers, communities and large-scale water infrastructure like dams


REPRESENTATIVE PIC

- The SANDRP claimed that many of Ambad's residents have been forced to consume and rely on contaminated water due to low and inconsistent supply from the Nashik Municipal Corporation

The chemical's source could be electroplating, metal finishing, paint and other industries located in the Ambad Maharashtra Industries Development Corporation (MIDC) zone, according to the network.

The SANDRP claimed that many of Ambad's residents have been forced to consume and rely on contaminated water due to low and inconsistent supply from the Nashik Municipal Corporation. As a result, people, including children and women, suffered from chemical ulcers, rashes and blisters, it said.

"Young women and children had painful, swollen lymph nodes and chronic illnesses. Two women in the affected settlement report suffering spontaneous miscarriages. The number can be higher. The link has to be assessed," the statement said.

It also highlighted that the regulatory response had been "inadequate" despite repeated complaints on multiple occasions.

"The Maharashtra Pollution Control Board (MPCB) issued a routine show-cause notice to only a single company on September 30, 2026, after media reports of yellow water emerged," the network added.

The MPCB neither made its water testing data public nor communicated it to the affected residents, "leaving the community in the dark about a lethal chemical hazard", the SANDRP said.

EDITORIAL

Boundaries of Authority

The restrictions surrounding the protests in Delhi have brought into focus the uneasy relationship between public order and constitutional liberty. Reports of mass detentions, transport restrictions and curbs on public assembly raise a fundamental question: how far can the state go in preventing anticipated disorder without undermining the freedoms it is constitutionally obliged to protect? The right to peaceful assembly, guaranteed under Article 19, is not absolute, and governments have a legitimate responsibility to safeguard citizens, maintain essential services and prevent violence. Yet these responsibilities cannot become an unrestricted licence to curtail democratic participation. Preventive policing must be guided by demonstrable threats rather than apprehensions about inconvenience or disruption. A protest may create traffic congestion or require additional security arrangements, but such consequences do not automatically establish a threat to public order. The distinction between managing a demonstration and effectively preventing it is crucial.

The scale of the restrictions makes the principle of proportionality particularly relevant. Judicial scrutiny of detentions and transport closures has raised questions about whether less restrictive alternatives were adequately considered. Authorities may legitimately regulate protest routes, designate assembly areas, deploy additional personnel and intervene against individuals engaging in violence. However, closing transport networks, restricting communications or detaining people merely because they intend to participate in demonstrations raises constitutional concerns. Such measures affect not only protesters but also workers, patients, students and countless others unconnected with the agitation. Public inconvenience caused by preventive restrictions may become greater than the disruption authorities seek to avoid. Equally important is transparency. Restrictions must rest on identifiable legal provisions, clearly recorded reasons and defined time limits. They should remain open to prompt judicial examination. Otherwise, exceptional measures risk becoming routine instruments of crowd control, weakening the distinction between preserving order and suppressing lawful dissent.

A constitutional democracy must accommodate disagreement even when it is inconvenient, politically uncomfortable or administratively demanding. The state is entitled to prevent violence, protect critical infrastructure and ensure that competing rights are respected. Protest organisers, too, have responsibilities: demonstrations must remain peaceful, lawful and mindful of the safety and mobility of others. But these obligations cannot justify treating every anticipated gathering as a potential emergency. The proper response to competing constitutional interests is careful balancing, not the automatic prioritisation of administrative convenience. Police decisions must be evidence-based, narrowly tailored and subject to meaningful accountability, particularly when they interfere with personal liberty and essential public services. Judicial oversight remains indispensable, but institutional safeguards should operate before restrictions are imposed, not merely after their consequences become apparent. Delhi's experience illustrates why clear protocols governing preventive detention, transport restrictions and permission for assemblies are necessary. The legitimacy of public order measures depends not simply on preventing gatherings, but on protecting citizens while preserving space for peaceful democratic expression. Administrative convenience cannot substitute for constitutional necessity.

LETTER

letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Deadly Migration Routes

The deaths of 109 migrants off Djibouti expose the desperation driving people towards dangerous journeys. Poverty, conflict and unemployment continue to push vulnerable families into overcrowded boats. Governments must strengthen rescue operations, dismantle trafficking networks and create safer migration pathways. Human lives cannot remain casualties of economic inequality.

ANIRBAN CHATTERJEE,
KOLKATA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, *Millennium Post*, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

The Voter Who Suddenly Isn't

When 13.37 crore disappear from draft electoral rolls, the figure is too large to imagine. Behind every missing name is an Indian citizen facing a brutal problem

TALKING SHOP



RAJEEV NARAYAN

THE WRITER IS A JOURNALIST & COMMUNICATIONS SPECIALIST



For the citizen, the first shock is brutally simple: 'My name is missing'

"The vote is most precious."
– John Lewis

Imagine discovering that you exist everywhere except where it matters most. Your Aadhaar may say you are you. Your bank account may say you are you. Your electricity bill, school records, ration card, passport, property papers, tax records and mobile number may all carry the same name. But open the electoral roll and... You are not there.

That is the harsh reality behind the staggering 13.37 crore names left out of the draft electoral rolls after the Special Intensive Revision of voter lists across 30 states and Union territories. It is important to remember that these are draft-roll exclusions, not 13.37 crore confirmed cases of ineligible citizens being permanently deleted.

There is a process of claims, objections and re-enrolment still available. The Election Commission has also directed states where the exercise is complete to conduct special drives to enrol voters left out of the rolls. But that explanation, while necessary, does not make the anxiety disappear. Because for the citizen, the first shock is brutally simple: "My name is missing."

The Paperwork

Then begins the great Indian pilgrimage of proving that you are who you say you are. Documents. Old records. Addresses. Dates. Applications. Queues. Websites. Forms. Searches that do not work. Officials who are already dealing with thousands of cases. Elderly people trying to understand procedures. Families discovering that one member is on the roll while another has vanished.

For a migrant worker, a tenant, a person who has changed homes, a woman whose name or address changed after marriage, an elderly citizen or somebody whose records contain a spelling or address mismatch, this can become more than an administrative inconvenience.

Reports have shown how bewildering the exercise can feel on the ground. In Chandigarh, for instance, nearly 200,000 names

CRORES OF NAMES MISSING. LAKHS OF QUESTIONS. ONE BASIC DEMOCRATIC RIGHT AT STAKE

were missing from the draft roll, including long-time residents who had voted for decades. This is the point where the debate needs to move beyond numbers.

The electoral roll is not merely another government database. It is the register that gives a citizen access to one of the most fundamental acts of citizenship: choosing who governs. If the name is absent, the citizen may still be an Indian citizen. But on polling day, citizenship alone does not put a ballot paper—or its electronic equivalent—in the voter's hands. That is a serious distinction.

More Than A Vote

The deeper problem is psychological. A country cannot casually make people feel that their existence is conditional on their ability to navigate paperwork. Voting is not a privilege handed out by the state as a favour. For an eligible citizen, it is a constitutional democratic right, subject to the law. The system, therefore, has two equally important responsibilities: keep ineligible names out, and make absolutely certain that eligible citizens are not stranded outside it.

The first protects the integrity of elections. The second protects the integrity of citizenship. The consequences of getting the second part wrong are larger than one election.

India has spent decades building systems around the idea that an ordinary citizen can establish an identity, obtain documents, send children to school, access subsidised food, receive welfare, open a bank account, travel, work and participate in public life without having to repeatedly prove that he or she belongs here.

That is what makes the sight of crores of people suddenly having to ask, "Am I still on the voter list?" so unsettling. There is also something deeply embarrassing about it—not because India is undertaking a revision of its electoral rolls. Clean and accurate rolls are essential to a functioning democracy. The embarrassment lies in the possibility that a citizen who has lived, worked, paid taxes, raised a family and voted for years can be made to feel like an administrative stranger in his own country.

Sensible Way Out

There is a lesson here for everyone. The Election Commission must be able to clean electoral rolls. Citizens must be able to challenge exclusions. Political parties must have a role in scrutiny. The system must be tough on bogus entries without becoming intimidating for genuine voters. But the burden of correction should not fall disproportionately on the person who has already been left out.

The sensible path is straightforward: make inclusion easier than exclusion. If a name is missing from a draft roll, the citizen should be told why, what evidence is required, where to submit it and how the case will be resolved. Quickly. There should be simple digital and physical routes, accessible assistance for the elderly and vulnerable, and enough time for genuine mistakes to be corrected.

Most importantly, a citizen who was on the electoral roll should not feel that he has suddenly become a new applicant for the right to vote. The number 13.37 crore is so enormous that it risks becoming just another headline. It should not. Behind that number are 13.37 crore names. And behind every name is a person who expects the Republic to know that he or she exists. That is not too much to ask.

Views expressed are personal

Deepening Ideological Divide

Competing political ideologies have turned Dhaka University into a battleground over historical identity

HISTORICAL FAULTLINES



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED IPS OFFICER, ADVISER NATSTRAT



Tensions have been growing between religious conservatives secular groups

A new standoff between religious hardliners and liberals in Bangladesh, particularly among students, has come to the fore. This has rocked Dhaka University, where students have historically led major protests that have impacted national politics.

On September 14, a group of students protested against the display of photographs of Pakistan's founder, Muhammad Ali Jinnah, and convicted war criminal Ghulam Azam at the Dhaka University Central Students' Union (DUCSU) Museum by placing photographs on the floor and trampling them. The protest continued on September 15, with students from the 2025-26 academic session participating. One of the protesters, Wasim Uddin Rahat, said Bangladesh is the country of students who had shed their blood for the language (Bangla). Hence, it can never tolerate giving a place at Dhaka University to someone who wanted to rob the country of its language. The students further alleged that Ghulam Azam was a notorious Razakar whose photograph had never been given a place at DUCSU. His photographs were placed on the ground as a symbol of hatred and should remain under the feet of the people.

It may be reiterated that Pakistan's founder and Muslim League leader, Muhammad Ali Jinnah, had a pathological hatred for East Pakistan, belittling its people and Bangla while asserting that Urdu must be the dominant language and Bangla could never be accepted. This led to the student movement turning violent in 1952 and strengthened Bangla nationalism. Since then, Jinnah has been hated, and his two-nation theory was shattered in 1971, giving birth to Bangladesh as a free nation.

Earlier, the DUCSU Museum was inaugurated on September 13 following renovations. Although the museum did not include any solo or prominent photographs of Sheikh Mujibur Rahman, the leader of Bangladesh's independence movement, it displayed three photographs of Muhammad Ali Jinnah. One was taken at the then Racecourse Ground (now Suhrawardy Udyan) on March 21, 1948, where Jinnah declared that "Urdu alone will be the state language of Pakistan." This was perhaps found insulting by progressive students.

Continuing with the protests, leaders and activists of the Students' Federation of Bangladesh's Dhaka University unit

DISPLAY OF JINNAH'S PHOTOGRAPHS HAS REVIVED PAINFUL MEMORIES OF BANGLADESH'S STRUGGLE FOR LINGUISTIC IDENTITY

joined a protest at the DUCSU archive on September 14, where a student had earlier torn up photographs of Muhammad Ali Jinnah. Students reiterated that they had not forgotten 1971 or the Language Movement, asking why "this villain's" photograph should remain at DUCSU and whether its manifesto had promised to "make Jinnah a hero".

Later, the federation put up a photograph in the archive showing convicted 1971 war criminal and former Jamaat-e-Islami (JeI) Ameer Ghulam Azam being beaten with shoes by local people outside a prominent square in Dhaka on January 1, 1981. Meanwhile, Dhaka University authorities warned of strict administrative action if DUCSU continued activities without university approval. The university said there was no scope for any "parallel administration" on campus and that DUCSU must operate within existing laws, regulations and policies. It also objected to the display of photographs of Muhammad Ali Jinnah and Abdul Malek at the archive, saying their inclusion was incompatible with the history of the Language Movement and the Liberation War. The university further criticised DUCSU's launch of a separate website for evaluating teachers without approval.

The administration said the university already had an approved teaching evaluation policy and alleged that the DUCSU website had made teachers' personal information public. While recognising DUCSU as an important student-representative institution, it warned that any attempt to establish a "parallel structure" by bypassing the administration would be "strictly resisted".

Judging by these developments, there appears to be a vertical polarisation between religious hardliners at Dhaka University and secular and liberal groups. While religious adherents are drawing inspiration and support from JeI, which has a considerable presence in the Bangladesh Parliament, the pro-Mujibur faction has the encouragement of liberal and forward-thinking elements. If pro-Jamaat elements and their affiliates continue to encourage the resurgence of Jinnah and persons of his ideology, Islamic fundamentalist forces in Bangladesh could fuel it further, influencing public opinion in a manner unconducive to progressive ideology.

Most crucially, a direct and possibly violent showdown between the two polarised camps remains a strong possibility. This may also provide an opportunity for the relatively dormant Awami League (AL) cadres to step in and occupy the space. Further, if the Dhaka University incident goes unchecked, the unrest might spread to universities such as Chittagong and Rajshahi, which are equally volatile politically. Perhaps the government needs to intervene effectively and contain the spiralling situation before it is too late.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Pope to undergo surgery to remove nodule on his lung

NVATICAN CITY: Pope Leo XIV announced Sunday he will undergo surgery in the coming days to remove a nodular lesion on his lung that was recently discovered during medical checks.

The 71-year-old pope said the lesion was found at an early stage and was "circumscribed" or well-localised. The Vatican later said Leo would undergo surgery in the first days of the week, with an expected recovery time of a week. The American pope made the announcement during his Sunday noon blessing.

China, Pakistan armies to hold joint drills

BEIJING: China and Pakistan will hold joint military exercises in Xinjiang region this month, official media reported on Sunday.

The two armies will conduct the "Karakoram 2026" joint training exercise in Korla in northwest China's Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region in mid and late October, official media quoted Chinese Defence Ministry spokesperson as saying.

Chen said the exercise would help the two sides deepen cooperation and strengthen interoperability in counter-terrorism operations.

Egypt's Fayoum mummy portraits to travel abroad

CAIRO: Egypt unveiled Sunday a restored version of the "Tondo of the Two Brothers," a prized 2nd-century painting from the famed Fayoum portraits.

Specialists from Rome worked alongside conservators from the Egyptian Museum in Tahrir for three weeks to restore the artwork, officials said at a press conference. Fayoum mummy portraits were painted primarily on thin wooden panels and placed over the faces of the deceased within mummy wrappings.



People salvage the contents of their destroyed mini mart in the aftermath of Hurricane Isaias in Milton AP/PTI

Briefs

Plot to attack Polish PM Tusk

WARSAW: A man suspected of threatening and planning to attack Polish Prime Minister Donald Tusk was arrested, the country's interior minister said Sunday.

Interior Minister Marcin Kierwinski gave no details about the identity of the man nor the type of attack planned.

Poland has been on high alert following a series of school stabbings this week, as well as fears of a possible Russian hybrid attack to weaken Western support for Ukraine in its war against Moscow's full-scale invasion.

"The man who threatened an attack was detained," Tusk wrote on X. "Thanks to the police for fast and decisive action."

US: 4 dead from Isaias storm

PANAMA: Isaias peeled off hotel and condominium rooftops and facades along the Florida Panhandle before charging north Saturday, dishing out torrential rains and the threat of flash floods and tornadoes across the Southeast.

At least four deaths were linked to the storm, including two people killed when trees fell onto homes in Florida and Alabama. Nearly 700,000 customers were without power by midday, and forecasters warned that flooding could stretch into the southern Appalachians.

Isaias came ashore as a Category 2 hurricane on Friday near Destin, Florida, a popular Gulf Coast vacation spot filled with high-rises and quirky tourist shops. The storm weakened overnight and was downgraded to a post-tropical cyclone but remained dangerous.

OVER 900 MIGRANTS DIED OR WENT MISSING ALONG ROUTE LAST YEAR

139 migrants, including children, die after boat capsizes off Djibouti

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Geneva, October 11

At least 139 people, including children, have died after a boat carrying 305 migrants capsized off the coast of Djibouti in east Africa, the International Organisation for Migration said Sunday.

At least 84 people remained missing in one of the deadliest shipwrecks yet on the popular but perilous crossing from the Horn of Africa to the Arabian Peninsula, where many migrants seek work in rich Gulf nations.

The boat was travelling from Djibouti to Yemen when it capsized on Thursday night or Friday morning, according to the IOM. More than 80 people survived, all of them Ethiopian nationals, it said.

Personal items likely belonging to the migrants, including shoes, were seen on a beach in a video shared by IOM. Rescue work continued as fears grew for the missing.

Tens of thousands of migrants from the Horn of Africa travel every year through Djibouti and across the Bab el-Mandeb Strait towards Gulf countries in search of safety and economic opportunities, the IOM said in its statement.

That movement has continued despite newly escalating fighting in Yemen, on the other side of the strait.

"This is a devastating loss of life," said Alexandre Coissac, IOM Chief of Mission in Djibouti. "This tragedy is a stark reminder of the dangers faced by migrants along this migration corridor as they seek economic opportunities."

"No one gets into a boat like that unless they believe there is no other safe way," IOM Director General Amy Pope said.

"We cannot keep treating these deaths as normal. Safe and legal pathways save lives. I am asking governments and donors to act before the next boat goes down."

Over 900 migrants died or went missing along the route last year, according to IOM's Missing Migrants Project.



Representational Image

KEY POINTS

- At least 84 people remained missing in one of the deadliest shipwrecks yet on the popular but perilous crossing
- The boat was travelling from Djibouti to Yemen when it capsized on Thursday night perhaps
- That movement has continued despite newly escalating fighting in Yemen, on the other side of the strait

Pak President imposes emergency in KPK

Cites worsening security situation

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Islamabad, October 11

Pakistan on Sunday declared an emergency in the northwest Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province citing the deteriorating law and order situation, bringing the provincial government led by jailed former prime minister Imran Khan's party to an end.

An emergency allows Pakistan's federal government to assume key executive and legislative powers in a province during a security crisis or breakdown of constitutional governance.

President Asif Ali Zardari proclaimed Articles 232(1) and 234(1) of the Constitution, citing rising terrorist attacks and a breakdown of constitutional machinery in the northwestern province, according to the presidential declaration.

Under the proclamation, Chief Minister Sohail Afridi, provincial ministers, advisers, special assistants and the advocate general will immediately vacate their offices.



Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa was the only province where Khan's Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI) was in power.

The move comes amid an ongoing protest march led by Afridi, who is pressing for Khan's release and access to medical treatment for him, the release of his sisters and supporters arrested ahead of the protest, and a medical examination of his wife, Bushra Bibi.

At least 11 Indians among over 300 injured in attack at Saudi airport

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Dubai, October 11

At least 11 Indians were among the more than 300 people injured in an attack at Saudi Arabia's international airport in Riyadh, the Indian Embassy said on Sunday a day after the attack that killed 12 people.

The Indian Embassy in Riyadh, in a social media post, on Sunday said it has been following up on the "dastardly attack" on Riyadh airport and was in touch with the local authorities to enquire about their well-being.

The attack was the latest of several in the past week targeting the airport. The deceased included four Saudi citizens, two Bangladeshi nationals, a Palestinian, a US citizen, an Egyptian, a Jordanian, a Syrian and a Sudanese.

"It is learnt that 11 Indians are among those injured in the attack. Embassy has been in touch with local authorities to enquire about their well-being.

Our officials have also reached out to the hospital authorities," the embassy said.

Strongly condemning the incident, India on Sunday said the repeated attacks on civilians and civilian infrastructure in the Gulf nation are "completely unacceptable and must cease immediately".

The kingdom said Sunday that schools in the capital would hold classes online until the end of the week.

Landslide, temporary dam breach may have triggered Nepal flash flood

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, October 11

A landslide and the possible breach of a temporary river blockage may have triggered a flash flood in Nepal's Budhi Gandaki river system early Sunday, according to a Kathmandu-based intergovernmental organisation.

The flood that struck Nepal around 4 am local time swept away houses and bridges in Gorkha district and damaged hydropower infrastructure.

At least 10 people remain missing, while nearly 50 people have been rescued, according to Nepali authorities.

The flood may have been caused by the failure of a temporary blockage created by a landslide near Chumchet in Gorkha district, the International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development (ICIMOD) said in a statement, citing preliminary accounts from Nepal's authorities. Floodwaters carried mud, sediment and debris downstream along the Budhi Gandakicorridor, prompting authorities to warn communities along the Budhi Gandaki, Trishuli and Narayani river systems as water levels fluctuated and risks increased. Initial reports indicate that people are missing, houses have been washed away, bridges lost and riverside infrastructure damaged.

Floodwaters also swept away a construction camp and equipment at the 341-MW Budhi Gandaki hydropower project in Salleri, although the full extent of the damage remains unclear.



An aerial view shows mudslide debris and floodwaters overflowing the Budhi Gandaki river following a sudden flash flood triggered by a suspected landslide in the Chekampar, area on Sunday

INITIAL REPORTS INDICATE THAT PEOPLE ARE MISSING, HOUSES HAVE BEEN WASHED AWAY, BRIDGES LOST AND RIVERSIDE INFRASTRUCTURE DAMAGED

Ukraine steps up strikes on Russia's tech infrastructure

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, October 11

A Ukrainian drone attack shut down a data center run by Russian technology giant Yandex, the company said Sunday as Kyiv widens its campaign against infrastructure deep inside Russia.

The attack on the data center in the city of Vladimir caused outages across Yandex's services, leaving users in dozens of Russian cities and in Kazakhstan, Belarus and Armenia unable to order taxis or access banking services, as per Russian news outlet Astra.

UN officials, experts call for systemic solutions to heat crisis

El Nino could have substantial impacts on rainfall, temperature patterns & risks of floods, drought and extreme heat

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Bangkok, October 11

Heat is an immediate crisis requiring urgent action to save lives, protect livelihoods and safeguard economies, a senior UN official has said, calling for collective efforts to translate scientific knowledge into practical solutions.

Speaking to PTI Videos on the sidelines of Bangkok Climate Action Week, Ben Churchill, Director of the regional office for Asia and the Pacific at World Meteorological Organisation, highlighted the importance of turning vast knowledge on heat, rising temperatures and their impacts into action that can save lives and protect livelihoods. "Heat is not a future problem; it's a problem now, and it's everybody's business. Yet for many years it has never been anyone's key responsibility. The forum has seen an unprecedented turnout, all wanting to find solutions and help scale them up," Churchill said.

"My takeaway is that moments like these are when we need to come together and turn the vast knowledge we have about heat, rising temperatures, and their impacts into action that can save lives, protect livelihoods, and contribute to social and economic development," he added.

In September, the WMO warned that the prevailing El Nino conditions over the equatorial Pacific are most likely to intensify into a very strong event in the coming months and persist through February 2027.

It said this could have substantial impacts on rainfall and temperature patterns and the associated risks of floods, drowught and extreme heat.

The inaugural Global Heat Forum, part of Bangkok Climate Action Week, concluded on October 9, convening nearly 700 scientists, business leaders, philanthropists, and health experts to drive immediate action and strengthen heat governance to protect global livelihoods.

James Abraham, CEO of the Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW), termed heat as a dual local and global issue.



No action to harm India's security concerns: SL Prez

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Colombo, October 11

Sri Lankan President Anura Kumara Dissanayake on Sunday assured that the island nation will not allow its territory or airspace to be used in a manner that threatens India's security.

Addressing a public gathering at Nikaweratiya in the Northwestern province, he said, "Our seas, our land would never be allowed to be used for any hostile act against our neighbour India."

FDI INFLOWS FROM JAPAN STOOD AT $5.71 BILLION IN Q1 FY27

Japan largest FDI source for India during first quarter of current fiscal

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11



KEY POINTS

- The foreign inflows from Japan account for nearly 29% of the total equity inflows ($19.81 billion) which India received in the quarter, the data showed
- The investments from Japan are important as Japan had set a target of investing 10 trillion yen (about Rs seven lakh crore) in India in over a decade

Japan has emerged as the largest source of FDI into India during April-June of the current fiscal year, according to government data. FDI inflows from Japan stood at $5.71 billion in the first quarter of 2026-27, surpassing the $3.74 billion India received from the country during the entire 2025-26 fiscal year. It was $2.48 billion in 2025-26.

The foreign inflows from Japan account for nearly 29 per cent of the total equity inflows ($19.81 billion) which India received during the quarter, the data showed. The investments from Japan are important as Japan had set a target of investing 10 trillion yen (about Rs seven lakh crore) in India in over a decade.

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal visited Japan last month to further boost bilateral trade and investment ties between the countries. Goyal in Nagoya stated that Japanese firms have already invested Rs 1 lakh crore of the 10 trillion Yen (around Rs 6 lakh crore) investment target in India over a decade, as committed in 2025.

According to Anil Talreja, Partner, Deloitte India, Japanese institutional investors are becoming much more active and Japanese financial institutions are increasing their engagement with India. "Japan is increasingly diversifying its supply chains. Japanese companies are reassessing their dependence on certain geographies on account of geopolitical tensions, slower growth rate, rising labour and manufacturing costs, and tariff risks," he said.

Talreja added that India is also positioning Japanese capital as particularly valuable because it brings technology, manufacturing capability, supply-chain integration and long-term capital, rather than simply financial investment.

Artificial intelligence, semiconductors, critical minerals, batteries, energy and next-generation mobility have been identified as key areas for future cooperation," he said, adding the automotive sector attracted the largest volume of Japanese industrial equity.

"The Q1 FY27 spike was not primarily the result of greenfield manufacturing investments. Instead, it was significantly driven by major financial-sector transactions and acquisitions. Banking and financial services, technology, digital infrastructure and Global Capability Centres (GCCs) are accounting for a larger share of Japanese investment," Talreja said.

This suggests that Japanese firms are increasingly viewing India not only as a manufacturing base but also as a large consumer market, technology and innovation hub, and GCC, he added. India has dedicated industrial townships specifically designed for Japanese investors. 12 JITs (Japanese industrial townships) across nine states. They provide Japan-specific infrastructure - including translation and facilitation support through dedicated Japan desks, Japanese-standard utilities, residential clusters with Japanese amenities, single-window regulatory coordination through Japan Plus & JETRO.

Echoing similar views, Rudra Kumar Pandey, an equity partner at Shardul Amarchand Mangaldas & Co, said that Japan's lead in the latest quarter signals strong confidence in India.

"Large strategic transactions have driven the headline figures, while Japanese companies' expansion plans point to a deeper, long-term opportunity across manufacturing, financial services and technology," Pandey said.

"The surge reflects new strategic investments and platform entries alongside continued expansion by established Japanese companies. Financial services, construction and logistics are driving the latest wave, with automotive, batteries, industrial manufacturing, renewable energy, food processing and insurance adding depth," he added.

In April, Japan's MUFG Bank acquired 20 per cent stake in Shriram Finance Ltd (SFL) for Rs 39,618 crore (about $4.4 billion). The transaction represents the largest cross-border investment in India's financial services sector. "Financial services are driving recent large transactions, while construction & logistics have become increasingly important platforms for Japanese participation. Automotive & components, batteries, manufacturing, renewable energy, food processing & insurance are also attracting investment or supporting established Japanese businesses in India," Pandey said.

He added that semiconductors, railways and defence represent promising areas for the next phase.

Musk vows affordable Starlink in India days ahead of Reliance Jio IPO

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11



Elon Musk

Tech trillionaire Elon Musk has said Starlink's pricing in India would have to be made affordable, since no one would buy it if it were too expensive, and argued that competition would give consumers more choice.

Musk's comments on X, part of a larger post, come as Jio Platforms, the digital arm of Reliance Industries, counts down to what is expected to be India's biggest public offering.

"The reality is that competition would greatly benefit the average citizen in India by giving them more choices, as it always does. Ambani's profits will be lower, but he is not going out of business," Musk said.

Musk added: "And, obviously, if Starlink is too expensive in India, no one will buy it, so SpaceX will need to make pricing affordable."

In the same post, Musk renewed his attack on Mukesh Ambani over Starlink's entry into India, accusing the billionaire's supporters of indulging in "absurd hypocrisy and hyperbole" in arguing simultaneously that his satellite internet service cannot compete with "amazing low prices offered by Ambani's de facto monopoly in India", and claiming - in the same breath - that it poses a strong competitive threat.

"On the one hand, they say Starlink couldn't possibly compete with the amazing low prices offered by Ambani's de facto monopoly in India and then, in the same breath, they essentially claim that Starlink would be too strong of a competitor! This is absurd hypocrisy and hyperbole," Musk wrote, claiming that the "ridiculous arguments" by Ambani's online supporters made no sense to him.

The latest post comes amid Musk's scathing criticism of Ambani, over what he saw as a persistent delay in the launch of Starlink satellite broadband services in India. Reliance has not publicly responded to Musk's allegations, while the government has maintained that the country's authorisation framework for telecom and satellite services is "fair and non-discriminatory" and that any suggestion that it was being applied selectively is "baseless and misconceived".

At the India Mobile Congress this week, as Musk's dramatic confrontation and swipes played out on X in the backdrop of India's swanky annual showcase of its telecom prowess, Reliance Jio Infocomm Chairman Akash Ambani declined to comment on the ongoing debate over satellite communication services, saying the company was focused on delivering value to Indian consumers.

On Friday, Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia asserted that India does not permit monopolies in any sector, and that despite the buzz around one particular company, three players - in fact - have received satcom licences and can start operations after meeting the security requirements and milestones.

Three entities - Musk's Starlink, Reliance Jio's satellite venture Jio Satcom, Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb - have already secured licences, while Amazon's Project Kuiper has expressed interest and will need to follow the established procedure.

Jio is building a satellite constellation of more than 1,600 low-Earth orbit satellites, supported by 23 ground stations. Starlink, operated by Musk's SpaceX, has more than 11,000 satellites in its constellation.

Musk's relentless attacks on Ambani come at a crucial time.

The IPO of Jio Platforms, which is expected to be the country's biggest issue, is likely to open for subscription on October 21 and listed on the stock exchanges on October 28.

FPIs pull out ₹44,166 cr from equities in Oct so far

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 11

Foreign investors have withdrawn Rs 44,166 crore from Indian equities so far in October, bringing the total outflows this year to more than Rs 3 lakh crore as elevated crude oil prices, a firmer US dollar and higher US bond yields weigh on investor sentiment.

Also, the artificial intelligence-led rally in North Asian markets attracts higher foreign capital.

The latest outflows follow a net withdrawal of Rs 35,861 crore in September. Before this, foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) had invested Rs 20,200 crore in Indian equities in July and Rs 29,631 crore in August, data from the NSDL showed.

With the latest selling, FPI withdrawals from Indian equities in 2026 have reached Rs 3.04 lakh crore, significantly higher than the Rs 1.66 lakh crore recorded during the entire 2025, the data noted.

VK Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist at Geojit Investments Ltd, said massive FPI selling was the primary reason for the Indian market's underperformance this year, with the Nifty delivering negative returns of 13.87 per cent year-to-date in 2026.

From the perspective of foreign investors, withdrawing money from India was rational, given that the risk-free return on 10-year US government bonds was above 5.2 per cent, he said.

"So, as long as the US bond yields remain elevated, FPIs will continue to sell. The scenario will change when the valuations become attractive, and the risk-reward ratio turns favourable for investment," Vijayakumar said.

He added that the market had been trending downwards over the past two months, with elevated crude oil prices and high US bond yields emerging as two major headwinds.

Meanwhile, foreign investors also extended their selling to the debt market in September. They withdrew Rs 1,921 crore through the Fully Accessible Route (FAR) and Rs 233 crore through the Voluntary Retention Route (VRR), while investing Rs 4,729 crore through the general route.

Infosys sees no material impact from US PERM programme suspension

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 11

Infosys expects no material impact on its operations from the US decision to suspend new and pending applications under the Permanent Labor Certification (PERM) programme, it said in a regulatory filing.

The Bengaluru-headquartered company said it welcomed the opportunity to work with the US Department of Labor and other agencies to address queries.

Infosys said it had invested in building a strong local workforce and technology and innovation hubs in the US, and remained committed to employees, clients and communities while complying with applicable laws.

The US administration on Thursday suspended eight technology companies, including TCS, Infosys, Wipro, HCL Technologies, Capgemini, Cognizant, Microsoft & Adobe, from the programme, alleging it excluded American workers.

Industry data shows Indian IT firms have reduced filings. TCS submitted two applications in US financial year 2026, against 513 in 2025 and 1,804 in 2024. HCL filed 59 in 2026, compared with 323 in 2025.

TCS said the suspension would not affect client commitments or its talent strategy, adding it plans to hire 15,000 people in the US over the next five years.

Q2 earnings, inflation data, oil prices to guide stock markets this week: Analysts

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 11

Major quarterly earnings from companies like Wipro and HCL Tech, along with inflation figures, global trends, and crude oil price movements, will drive stock market movement this week, analysts said.

Market investors will also watch foreign investor trading activity, rupee movement, US Treasury yields, and geopolitical developments.

IT stocks emerged as major catalysts behind the market's sharp recovery on Friday, following an over 4 per cent rally in TCS after it reported better-than-expected September quarter results.

Forthcoming results this week are from BHEL, Canara Bank, HDB Financial Services, HDFC Asset Management Company and Nestle.

Domestically, September CPI and WPI inflation data will be closely tracked for signs of further price pressures, while the 2QFY27 earnings season gathers pace, he said.

'PNB Housing Finance sees 5-8 bps margin gain from rate hike'

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 11

PNB Housing Finance MD and CEO Ajai Shukla said the Reserve Bank's recent rate hike could improve the company's net interest margin by 5-8 basis points (bps).

The RBI raised its benchmark lending rate by 25 basis points to 5.5 per cent after a gap of almost four years to contain inflation fuelled by the West Asia crisis.

Shukla said the benefit would be limited as the company's borrowings comprise MCLR-linked loans, commercial paper, National Housing Bank refinance and non-convertible debentures, rather than being entirely linked to the repo rate.

"The benefit will not be 25 basis points immediately on the book, but it may be 5-8 basis points," he said.

On housing finance demand, Shukla said the company was witnessing good traction and expected the second half of the financial year to outperform the first.

Meanwhile, Crisil upgraded the company's rating to AAA/Stable from AA+/Stable, giving it AAA ratings from all four leading domestic agencies.

Shukla said the upgrade would lower borrowing costs, particularly on bank term loans, which account for 40 per cent of total resources, potentially making customer loans cheaper.

Adani's Kutch Copper plans 115 MW renewable energy integration, targets lower emissions

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 11

Adani Enterprises Ltd's Kutch Copper Ltd plans to integrate 115 megawatts of renewable energy into its Mundra refinery in Gujarat to reduce emissions, conserve water and improve resource efficiency.

The company currently operates a copper smelter with a capacity of 5,00,000 tonnes per annum and plans to expand it to 1 million tonnes, potentially making it the world's largest single-location custom smelter. In its maiden sustainability report, Kutch Copper said it aims to embed environmental, social and governance considerations into its operations amid rising copper demand from energy transition investments, electric mobility, power transmission & industrial expansion.



The planned renewable energy integration will help reduce the facility's carbon footprint and advance its long-term decarbonisation goals, the company said.

Kutch Copper operates on nearly 100 per cent desalinated water and follows a zero-liquid-discharge approach to reduce freshwater dependence. It is also treating 99.8 per cent of sulphur emissions using advanced environmental technologies. The company is investing in community programmes covering healthcare, education, livelihoods and social development. The Adani Group has committed $1.2 billion to the project. The group sees the domestic copper industry as important to India's goal of achieving carbon neutrality by 2070, supported by green infrastructure & environmental management.

IPO rush: Jio Platforms among dozen cos set to tap primary market in Oct

The proposed offerings span technology, healthcare, renewable energy, defence and precision manufacturing

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 11

A dozen companies, including Jio Platforms, Zetwerk Manufacturing Business and Avaada Electro, are set to tap the primary market in October to raise funds through initial public offerings, extending the strong fundraising momentum seen in 2026.

Other companies expected to launch IPOs this month include Fusion CX, HD Fire Protect, Tonbo Imaging, Bonfiglioli Transmissions, Sahajanand Medical Technologies, Paras Healthcare, NDR InvIT Trust, Gujarat Victory Forgings and SFC Environmental Technologies, according to merchant bankers.

The proposed offerings span technology, healthcare, renewable energy, defence and precision manufacturing. Companies plan to raise funds through fresh equity issues and offers for sale (OFS), with proceeds intended for expansion, capital expenditure, debt repayment, working capital and general corporate purposes.

Companies have raised over Rs 1.1 lakh crore through 96 IPOs so far in 2026, including 35 issues launched in September.

"India's primary market momentum continues into the second half with a robust pipeline. While secondary-market volatility and geopolitical developments may induce selective launch windows, the underlying appetite for quality paper remains structural," Neha Agarwal, MD and Head of Equity Capital Markets at JM Financial Ltd, said. She said institutional demand remained supported by deep domestic liquidity and selective foreign capital, despite fluctuating foreign institutional investor flows in the secondary market.

CLOSER LOOK

- Companies plan to raise funds through fresh equity issues and OFS, with proceeds intended for expansion, capex, debt repayment, working capital and general corporate purposes
- Jio Platforms IPO is scheduled to open on October 21 & close on October 23. The offering is likely to be India's largest IPO to date

Jio Platforms, Reliance Industries Ltd's telecom and digital services arm, is scheduled to open its IPO on October 21 and close it on October 23. The offering is expected to be India's largest IPO to date.

HD Fire Protect has fixed a price band of Rs 258-271 per share for its Rs 712-crore IPO, entirely an OFS by promoters, scheduled for October 13-15.

Fusion CX has set a price band of Rs 275-289 per share for its Rs 702-crore IPO, opening October 14 and closing October 16.

Zetwerk plans to raise around Rs 5,000 crore through a fresh issue of Rs 2,600 crore and an OFS of up to 9.68 crore equity shares. Its IPO is scheduled for October 15-19.

Tonbo Imaging has proposed an OFS of up to 1.22 crore equity shares, while Bonfiglioli Transmissions plans an OFS of up to 4.32 crore shares. Sahajanand Medical Technologies' IPO comprises an OFS of 1.38 crore shares. All three issues are scheduled for October 15-19.

Zetwerk, Tonbo Imaging, Bonfiglioli Transmissions and Sahajanand Medical Technologies are expected to announce their price bands and other details on Monday.

Avaada Electro plans to raise Rs 7,600 crore, Paras Healthcare Rs 1,800 crore and NDR InvIT Trust Rs 750 crore.

Gujarat Victory Forgings has proposed an IPO of up to 1.97 crore shares. These four offerings comprise fresh issues and OFS.

SFC Environmental Technologies has proposed a fresh issue worth Rs 150 crore and an OFS of 1.23 crore equity shares.

THE POLICY ALSO FOCUSES ON VALUE-ADDED STEEL

New steel policy targets 604 MT steel output, raw material security, exports

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, October 11



The government has released a draft National Steel Policy Vision 2047, aiming for 604 million tonnes of crude steel production, 302 kg of per capita consumption, and 45 MT of steel exports.

The NSP Vision 2047 provides a long-term policy framework to build a globally competitive, technologically advanced and environmentally sustainable steel sector aligned with the vision of Viksit Bharat@2047.

As per the draft policy brought for stakeholder consultation, the aim is also to increase raw-material security, such as iron ore and coking coal, reduce imports, and increase the share of high-end steel in the country's overall steel output. The government has proposed a new policy, even as the current National Steel Policy 2017 aims for 300 MT steel capacity by 2030, 160 kg per capita consumption, and ensuring raw material availability, among other goals.

"Manufacturing and infrastructure will remain the primary drivers of steel demand. Construction and infrastructure currently account for about 67 per cent of steel consumption, while automobiles, engineering goods, appliances and packaging contribute another 28 per cent," the policy draft said.

Demand will also be driven by rapid urbanisation, renewable energy expansion, clean mobility, digital infrastructure, and emerging technologies.

The Policy projects finished steel demand of 505 MT by 2047, requiring crude steel capacity of 604 MT, per capita consumption of 302 kg and steel exports of 45 MT, the draft National Steel Policy 2027 said.

Raw materials account for around 65-70 per cent of steelmaking costs. While India is largely self-sufficient in iron ore, it imports nearly 92 per cent of its coking coal requirement.

The new policy projects coking coal demand at 236 million tonnes by 2047, up from 72 million tonnes in 2025. Iron ore demand is projected at 772 million tonnes, up from 299 MT in 2025. The NSP 2017 estimated India's coking coal demand at 99 MT and coking coal at 299 MT.

The policy seeks to reduce import dependence through domestic mining, washery expansion, asset acquisition, long-term supply arrangements, and AI-based optimisation of coal blends. The policy will also keep other key raw materials, such as manganese and limestone, in focus to ensure long-term resource sustainability.

The secondary steel sector, comprising around 2,550 units and nearly 47 per cent of crude steel production capacity, will receive support for improved raw material access, technology improvement, skill development and safety.

Decarbonization is one of the key pillars of the Policy. The steel sector contributes about 10-12 per cent of India's CO_2 emissions, with an average emission intensity of 2.54 tonnes of CO_2 per tonne of crude steel (tCO2/tcs), significantly above the global average of 1.92 tCO2/tcs.

NSP Vision 2047 outlines a phased transition towards Net Zero by 2070 through improved energy efficiency, renewable electricity, greater scrap utilisation and use of hydrogen.

The draft policy also focuses on value-added steel such as stainless steel and speciality steel, addressing their dependence on imported raw materials and technology.

It proposes diversifying raw material sourcing, developing a domestic scrap ecosystem, promoting downstream manufacturing clusters, developing indigenous technology, establishing Centres of Excellence, and aggregating demand. Steel quality will be strengthened through revised Indian Standards and conformity assessment mechanisms.

KEY POINTS

- Raw materials like coking coal, Manganese, Limestone, will remain in policy focus to ensure long-term resource sustainability
- Decarbonisation is one of the key pillars of the policy. NSP Vision 2047 outlines a phased transition to achieve Net Zero by 2070

'India expanding trade footprint to boost global ties, empower MSMEs'

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, October 11



Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal

India is rapidly broadening its network of free trade agreements to integrate deeply with global economies, empower micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) & accelerate national economic expansion, Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said on Saturday.

Speaking at the 121st Annual Session of the PHD Chamber of Commerce and Industry, the Union Minister stated that New Delhi has concluded nine trade pacts covering 38 developed economies over the past four to four and a half years, transforming the country into an attractive destination for international trade.

Emphasizing the changing paradigm of global engagement, the Minister said, "When you see world leaders making up the line to engage with India to expand trading relations. After all, in the last 4 to 4.5 years, we have concluded 9 Free Trade Agreements. Collectively covering 38 developed nations."

Contrast was drawn with the trade pacts executed prior to 2014, with Goyal pointing out that those older agreements provided preferential access to an aggregate global gross domestic product of merely $10 trillion. He noted that earlier pacts often failed to prioritize domestic competitive advantage. Addressing ongoing bilateral and multilateral trade negotiations, the Minister highlighted substantial progress across key geographies.

"The UK process started on July 15th; the day after tomorrow their minister is coming, and we have a Joint Economic Commission. On the same day, perhaps the Canadian minister is also coming, or the next day on Tuesday. The UK is done; Canada is eager for us to hurry up," he added.

"The UAE and Oman are done; the remaining four Gulf countries, the GCC, have launched negotiations. All six of them as a group want to do a GCC FTA. Talks are going on with Israel; talks are going on with Chile. With Mexico, it will launch next week. Canada is moving forward rapidly. Eurasia, these Central Asian countries, talks are going on with them."

Goyal explained that trade pacts are no longer finalized solely within bureaucratic corridors. Instead, stakeholder consultations remain central to every round of discussions.

"And these days, when an FTA is signed, it's not done by government offices. It's decided after talking to the industry. It's decided after talking to farmers. The concerns of fishermen are heard. Keeping in mind the difficulties our MSMEs face and what matters to them," Goyal said. He affirmed that this inclusive mechanism ensures sensitive domestic sectors remain protected while opening up overseas demand.

"It's done through discussions with the economic community, farmers, fishermen, and for the benefit of the country. An agreement is made. This ensures we get enough opportunities in large numbers. If we see a sensitive sector, we handle it carefully," he mentioned.

Gold, silver set for range-bound week as rupee weakness offers support, say analysts

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 11

Gold and silver prices are likely to trade in a range with a slightly positive bias next week as rupee weakness cushions domestic bullion against global fluctuations, analysts said.

Traders will track inflation readings from India, China & the US. Trade data from Beijing and speeches from Federal Reserve will provide cues on whether the US central bank will deliver another rate hike in October or defer it to December, they added.

On the MCX, gold futures for December delivery gained Rs 1,109, or nearly 1 per cent, last week to settle at Rs 1.51 lakh per 10 grams. Silver, however, ended marginally lower by Rs 122 to Rs 2.25 lakh per kg.

In overseas markets, Comex gold futures for December delivery gained 54, or 1.3 per cent, last week to close at $4,216.3/ounce, while silver rose over 1 per cent to $61.05/ounce.

Analysts said interplay of currency movements, US rate expectations, geopolitical developments and investment demand is likely to determine whether bullion sustains its recent recovery or remains confined to a range in the next week.

Outlook for manufacturing sector demand improves for Q3FY27: RBI

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, October 11

India's manufacturing sector is expected to witness stronger demand in Q3FY27, even as cost pressures remain elevated, according to the RBI's Industrial Outlook Survey.

During Q2FY27, India's manufacturing sector witnessed an improvement in demand conditions compared with the previous quarter, supported by stronger production, order books and capacity utilisation.

However, raw material cost pressures remained elevated, while sentiment regarding selling prices moderated, it noted.

"Pressures from raw material costs remained elevated, while sentiments on selling prices showed moderation."

At the same time, the Business Assessment Index (BAI) rose to 104.4 in Q2FY27 from 100.4 in Q1FY27, which further indicates an improvement in overall business conditions.

Looking ahead to Q3FY27, manufacturing firms remained optimistic about demand, expecting improvements in "production, order books, capacity utilisation and exports."

However, cost pressures are likely to remain elevated, alongside expectations regarding selling prices and profit margins.

"Cost pressures are anticipated to remain elevated and so are the sentiments on selling prices and profit margins," it said. At the same time, it noted that the Business Expectations Index (BEI) also improved for Q3FY27, reflecting stronger business confidence.

For Q4FY27 and Q1FY28, manufacturing firms expect healthy demand conditions to continue, with a positive outlook on overall business conditions, production, order books and capacity utilisation. However, input cost pressures are likely to persist, prompting firms to pass on higher costs through increased selling prices.

IIT-B study bats to cut MDR to 0.08% from 0.4%

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 11

Merchant discount rate (MDR) on UPI transactions should be reduced to 0.08 per cent from 0.40 per cent, while banks should fund the payment infrastructure using earnings from CASA deposits, an IIT Bombay report has recommended.

The report, 'UPI at a Crossroads: Reintroducing the MDR', recommended reducing the share for third-party application providers (TPAPs), such as PhonePe & Google Pay, to 0.06 per cent from the 0.08 per cent recommended by theNPCI, while retaining payment service providers' share at 0.02 per cent.

The study proposed eliminating the 70 per cent share currently split between issuer and acquirer banks, arguing that banks are adequately compensated through interest margins earned on CASA deposits. Banks booked over Rs 4.85 lakh crore in net interest margin through CASA deposits in FY26, which it described as "large & disproportionate" compensation for providing minimal free services.

It suggested banks set aside about 3 per cent of the funds, or Rs 15,000 crore, sacrificed by CASA depositors to operate and improve UPI, rather than depend on MDR revenue from offline transactions. It also urged the RBI & government to make UPI a necessary banking service, similar to core banking solutions.

Questioning the Rs 300 transaction charge cap on peer-to-merchant payments of Rs 75,000 and above, it said the RBI's rules require service charges to remain proportionate to the average cost of providing services. If an ad valorem model is adopted, the cap should not exceed Rs 40 per transaction.

It proposed a digital payment fee for online purchases and called for reducing credit card MDR to address concerns that credit card users burden UPI users. It also urged the RBI to reconsider free ATM withdrawal allowances and continue the Payments Infrastructure Development Fund to help payment aggregators onboard merchants.

The report warned that excessive charges could erode public trust in UPI. It suggested restricting MDR to merchants with annual turnover exceeding Rs 50 crore, or about 4 crore/month, covering about 90 per cent of proposed MDR.

NPCI's September 15 circular introduced a 0.4 per cent MDR on P2M UPI payments above Rs 2,000, payable by merchants & capped at Rs 300 for transactions of Rs 75,000 or more. Person-to-person transfers and most everyday merchant payments remain free. Essential services attract Rs 5 per transaction above Rs 2,000, while capital market transactions carry a 0.02 per cent rate, capped at Rs 300.

NTPC invites EoI from commercial & industrial cos to invest 26% equity in co-generation projects

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, October 11



NTPC Ltd has invited Expressions of Interest (EOI) from Commercial and Industrial (C&I) entities interested in taking 26 per cent equity in co-generation projects.

The initiative aims to explore opportunities to develop co-generation facilities to meet industrial requirements for steam and electricity, along with integrated power supply solutions based on coal, renewable energy and Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS), NTPC Ltd said.

With industries increasingly focusing on energy security, cost optimisation and sustainability, co-generation offers an opportunity to enhance overall energy efficiency by producing steam and electricity through an integrated system.

The proposed initiative seeks to address the diverse requirements of industries with reliable, economical and sustainable energy solutions through long-term power supply arrangements. By leveraging its expertise in power generation and exploring innovative energy supply models, NTPC Ltd aims to support industrial growth while contributing to energy efficiency, sustainability and energy transition objectives.

NTPC Ltd is India's largest integrated power utility with an installed capacity of over 91 GW, with another 35+ GW under construction.

The company has set a target to reach 149 GW of total capacity by 2032, including 60 GW from renewable energy sources. This includes a balanced mix of thermal, hydro, solar, and wind power plants, ensuring the supply of reliable, affordable, and sustainable electricity to the country.

'Bankers optimistic on Q3 loan demand except from agri sector'

AGENCIES
New Delhi, October 11

Banks expect credit demand to strengthen across most sectors of the Indian economy in Q3FY27, except agriculture, largely driven by seasonal demand, according to the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI) latest Bank Lending Survey (BLS).

The 37th round of the survey found that bankers remained optimistic about lending activity, while overall loan terms and conditions are expected to remain unchanged from Q2FY27.

"Bankers' expectations on loan demand improved across sectors (except for the agriculture sector) in Q3:2026-27, majorly driven by seasonal demand," the RBI said.

During Q2 FY2026-27, bankers reported improved optimism about credit demand across major economic sectors.

They also indicated some easing in loan terms and conditions at the aggregate level during the quarter.

Looking ahead, bankers expect credit demand to remain strong in Q4 FY2026-27 and Q1 FY2027-28, indicating sustained borrowing activity in the coming quarters.

The survey, conducted during Q2 FY2026-27, gathered responses from senior loan officers of major scheduled commercial banks. It assessed lending conditions during the quarter and captured expectations for Q3 FY2026-27, Q4 FY2026-27 and Q1 FY2027-28.

RBI's rupee defence may drain surplus banking liquidity, ease currency pressure

Kotak Mahindra Bank estimates that hedging costs could rise by 1-1.6%, while IDFC FIRST Bank projects an increase of around 1.5%

AGENCIES
Mumbai, October 11

The RBI's measures to curb rupee volatility could ease near-term depreciation pressure and withdraw surplus banking system liquidity, although persistent external pressures may limit the relief, according to research reports.

The measures, including a dedicated dollar window for oil marketing companies through designated banks and higher costs for certain foreign exchange hedging transactions, are expected to reduce spot-market dollar demand and curb speculative positions against the rupee.

"The immediate reaction on INR is expected to be very favourable-likely move of USD-INR towards sub-95 cannot be ruled out. Forward premia is likely to soften as OMCs and other importer hedging gets contained," Kotak Mahindra Bank said.

IDFC FIRST Bank also expects near-term moderation in USD/INR and forward premiums, but said the medium-term currency trajectory would depend on global factors and balance-of-payments dynamics.

In its October 10 circulars, the RBI barred authorised dealers from permitting the rebooking of cancelled rupee-linked forex derivative contracts, while allowing rollovers at maturity under existing regulations. It also lowered the threshold for undertaking foreign exchange derivative transactions without establishing an underlying exposure to $5 million from $100 million across authorised dealers and recognised stock exchanges.

The RBI introduced a Foreign Exchange Risk Reserve (FERR), requiring authorised dealers to maintain cash reserves with the RBI equivalent to 20 per cent of the rupee value of the notional amount of each rupee-linked foreign exchange derivative contract exceeding $2 million, when hedging current account exposures involving foreign currency purchases against the rupee.

The RBI said the steps aim to strengthen market discipline, improve risk management and maintain an orderly, transparent foreign exchange market.

Kotak estimates that hedging costs could rise by 1-1.6 per cent, while IDFC FIRST Bank projects an increase of around 1.5 per cent. The higher costs could discourage some importers from hedging, reducing dollar demand and easing forward premiums. However, elevated crude oil prices, FPI outflows and weak underlying capital flows could sustain depreciation pressure, IDFC FIRST Bank warned.

The measures could also influence monetary policy. If they curb speculative demand and reduce currency pressure, the RBI may adopt a gradual approach towards further rate hikes, the bank said, projecting a terminal repo rate of 6-6.25 per cent.

IDFC FIRST Bank estimates core liquidity surplus could decline to around Rs 2 lakh crore by March 2027 from Rs 10.4 lakh crore on October 2, reflecting currency leakage, balance-of-payments pressures and RBI liquidity operations.

Kotak estimates the measures could withdraw around Rs 1.5 lakh crore of durable liquidity if sustained for another month, alongside further withdrawals via open market bond sales & forex intervention.

The RBI has announced an open market sale of government securities worth Rs 25,000 crore for October. It has also raised the daily maintenance requirement for the CRR to 99 per cent from 90 per cent following a review of liquidity conditions.

CLOSER LOOK

- A dedicated dollar window for OMCs & higher costs for certain forex hedging transactions, are expected to reduce spot-market dollar demand and curb speculative positions against the rupee
- The measures could also influence monetary policy. If they curb speculative demand and reduce currency pressure, the RBI may adopt a gradual approach towards further rate hikes

Briefs

Book on Jagdale released

INDORE: Former India captain Sunil Gavaskar on Sunday released "Sanjay Jagdale: Rag-Rag Mein Cricket", a book on the life of former BCCI secretary Sanjay Jagdale, expressing hope that it would prove useful to young cricketers.

Referring to the book's title, Gavaskar said cricket ran through Jagdale's veins and that he had not only served the game but also dedicated his entire life to it.

Speaking at the launch of the book, authored by Kiran Waikar and Dr Sunil Dudhale, Gavaskar said Jagdale had served cricket in various capacities, including as a player, coach, manager, selector and administrator.

He said the book, which chronicles Jagdale's life and his contributions to cricket, would prove useful to young cricketers. the official, who did not wish to be named, said.

Sikkim hosts mountain biking event

GANGTOK: Sikkim on Sunday hosted the opening leg of the 2026 Zabarvan Extreme Legends Series, an international downhill mountain biking competition featuring riders from eight countries, as the Himalayan state seeks to strengthen its position as an adventure tourism destination.

Chief Minister Prem Singh Tamang flagged off the competition at Rock Garden in Soreng district's Zoom.

Riders from India, Iran, Australia, Brazil, Italy, the Czech Republic, Taiwan and Nepal took part in the event. Tamang congratulated the organisers and participating athletes, calling the event a historic milestone for the state and the Zoom-Salghari area, an official statement said.

He said hosting an international sporting event reflected the area's potential to emerge as a recognised destination for adventure sports and tourism. The Zabarvan Extreme Legends Series promotes downhill mountain biking across different terrains in India.

INDIA NOW LEAD THE FIVE-MATCH SERIES 2-1

Abhishek, Arshdeep power India to 14-run victory over WI in 3rd T20I

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Indore, October 11

Abhishek Sharma's scintillating 69 and pacer Arshdeep Singh's crucial three-wicket haul paved the way for India's 14-run victory against the West Indies in the third T20I here on Sunday.

India now lead the five-match series 2-1.

Abhishek's 30-ball knock (6x4, 5x6) and his century alliance with Ishan Kishan (37) drove India's charge with the bat which was undone a bit by sloppy effort in the middle-overs. India made 223 all out.

In reply, Arshdeep Singh (3/44) dealt a severe blow early when he cleaned up in-form WI skipper Shai Hope (5) in the second over, and accounted for Sherfane Rutherford (32) and Keemo Paul (10) later in the innings to seal the outcome of the contest.

The West Indies finished at 209 for seven.



India's Arshdeep Singh during the third T20I match of a series between India and West Indies, in Indore on Sunday PTI

The Caribbean side failed to recover from the early dismissal of Hope. Shimron Hetmyer (43, 26b; 4x6, 6x2) got a lifeline early, but he did not really capitalise.

Hetmyer, who looked in rhythm for a long haul which the West Indies needed, was cleaned up by Naman Dhir with an angled in delivery in the seventh over.

In the 10th over, Rovman Powell (5) perished trying to clear the ropes off Axar Patel. Kamil Pooran (42, 27b; 6x3, 4x6) was struggling to middle the ball halfway through the chase.

Pooran seemed to have shrugged off his struggles in the 11th over when he sent the ball into the stands thrice off Dhir (2/39), but the bowler had the last laugh, getting him caught by Arshdeep at square leg.

KEY POINTS

- The West Indies finished at 209 for seven
- Caribbean side failed to recover from the early dismissal of Hope
- Arshdeep Singh (3/44) dealt a severe blow early when he cleaned up in-form WI skipper Shai Hope (5) in the second over

Kerala Blasters begin season with 2-0 win over Inter Kashi



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Pune, October 11

Vibin Mohanan and Andre Green struck a goal each to help Kerala Blasters FC begin their Indian Super League (ISL) campaign with a 2-0 victory over Inter Kashi here on Sunday. Mohanan opened the scoring in the 18th minute before Green struck in stoppage time to seal all three points for the Blasters.

Kerala Blasters started on the front foot, with Freddy Lallawmawma firing from distance in the fifth minute.

Kashi responded a minute later as Rosenberg Gabriel tested goalkeeper Arsh Shaikh with an effort from the left side of the box, but the Kerala custodian was equal to the task.

Manvir Singh also threatened for Inter Kashi, sending an attempt over the crossbar as both sides looked to establish control in the opening exchanges.

Korou Singh provided the assist, setting up Mohanan to finish with a right-footed effort from the centre of the box and give Kerala the advantage.

Blasters continued to push for a second goal after the restart, with substitute Momo Yansane sending an effort wide shortly after coming on.

Cricket has become more innovative, with top Indian batters bringing different styles: Raina

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 11

'CRICKET HAS BECOME AN INNOVATIVE SPORT. ABHISHEK IS BATTING WELL. SHUBMAN IS PLAYING IN A DIFFERENT FORM. ROHIT AND VIRAT ARE PLAYING DIFFERENTLY IN 50 OVERS. WE ARE LUCKY THAT WE HAVE A LOT OF COACHES NOW'

Former India cricketer Suresh Raina believes the diversity of batting styles among India's top players has made the game more innovative, while terming Bhuvneshwar Kumar's return to the national squad the reward of hard work, discipline and consistent performances in domestic cricket.

"Cricket has become an innovative sport. Abhishek is batting well. Shubman is playing in a different form. Rohit and Virat are playing differently in 50 overs. We are lucky that we have a lot of coaches now.

"We have a lot of players who are playing different, fearless cricket. They are playing fantastically well and handling the pressure. It is so great to see everyone contributing strongly," Raina told mediapersons on the sidelines of the launch of the Indian Softball Cricket League here.

He is associated with the league as its brand ambassador.

Raina also congratulated Bhuvneshwar on his return to the Indian squad, saying the veteran pacer's dedication and discipline had paid off.

"Congratulations to Bhuvi. He has done a great job in recent times. He has played domestic cricket. I spoke to him. I met him. He is a busy cricketer. Hard work has paid off; it always pays off.

"At the age of 36, he has shown character. He has been a very disciplined bowler. He has been a very process-oriented guy. He has worked really hard on his body. I hope he does very well when he goes to New Zealand. Best wishes to him," Raina said.

Asked about India's consistent performances across formats, Raina attributed the team's success to the depth of talent available in the country.

"It has been happening. We have almost four-five teams now. We went to Japan and got a gold medal. There is going to be an Olympics in LA in 2028. A good team will be formed there as well. Congratulations to all the awardees, whether it is cricket or hockey," he said.

Pacer Rohit Sharma's five-for helps J&K bowl out MP for 196

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Srinagar, October 11

Defending champions Jammu and Kashmir made a strong start with the ball as medium pacer Rohit Sharma claimed five wickets to dismiss Madhya Pradesh for 196 on the opening day of their Ranji Trophy Elite Group A match here on Sunday.

Jammu and Kashmir, who elected to field, were 3/1 in three overs at stumps, trailing by 193 runs after losing opener Shubham Khajuria for a duck.

Rohit returned figures of five for 36 from 21.2 overs, while left-arm medium pacer Sunil Kumar took four wickets for 69 runs.

Madhya Pradesh were bowled out in 74.2 overs at the Sher-i-Kashmir Stadium.

MP captain Shubham Sharma was the mainstay of the innings, scoring 79 off 174 balls with eight fours.

He held the innings together after the visitors lost three wickets for 41 runs, including openers Yash Dubey (4) and Harsh Gawli (12), and wicket-keeper Himanshu Mantri (17).

Rohit accounted for Gawli and Mantri before dismissing Chanchal Rathore, who made 33 off 75 balls, and Atharva Mahajan, who was out for a duck.

His fifth wicket came when he dismissed Shubham, ending the captain's resistance and the MP innings.

Rathore and Shubham had helped steady the innings with a partnership that took the score past 100. However, MP lost wickets at regular intervals thereafter.

Aryan Pandey contributed 35 off 60 deliveries, striking six fours, but found little support from the lower order.

Sunil Kumar removed India all-rounder Saransh Jain, Pandey, India quick Avesh Khan and Ravi Kiran, while Auqib Nabi dismissed the last recognised resistance, accounting for Ravi Kiran.

Mandhana named UNICEF India celebrity advocate, Tendulkar welcomes batter

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, October 11



Newly appointed India women's cricket captain Smriti Mandhana has been named a celebrity advocate by UNICEF India, with the organisation seeking to leverage her influence to promote equal opportunities, health and well-being for adolescent girls.

The announcement was made on Sunday to mark the International Day of the Girl, which draws attention to girls' rights, safety, leadership and potential, while highlighting the barriers that continue to restrict their choices.

In her new role, Mandhana will support UNICEF India's efforts to empower adolescent girls, improve their health and well-being, and help them access opportunities to learn, play and lead.

"I am deeply honoured to join UNICEF India as a Celebrity Advocate. Growing up playing cricket taught me that every dream begins with an opportunity.

"With hard work, determination, and encouragement, that opportunity can turn into something extraordinary. Every child and young person deserves the chance to dream big and reach their full potential," Mandhana said.

Cricket icon Sachin Tendulkar, who is associated with UNICEF as its Regional Ambassador for South Asia and a long-time partner, welcomed the move.

"Welcome to the @UNICEFIndia family, @mandhana_smriti! You inspire millions on the field, and I know you will be a brilliant voice for children's rights off it," Tendulkar tweeted.

An Arjuna Award recipient, Mandhana was appointed captain of the Indian women's cricket team earlier this week after Harmanpreet Kaur stepped down from the role.

ISL: Churchill Brothers beat Mumbai City FC 2-1

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Fatorda, October 11

Churchill Brothers SC began their Indian Super League 2026-27 campaign with a 2-1 win over Mumbai City FC here on Sunday.

Gaurav Bora headed in the club's first-ever ISL goal in the 57th minute and Sebastian Gutierrez added a second in the 86th.

Sergio Llamas pulled one back from the penalty spot in the third minute of stoppage time, but it was not enough for the Islanders.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Open Tender Notice No. - JHSW-M-W-SC-2026-27-07

E-Tender Notice

E-tenders are invited from experienced or interested contractors on behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work-

Cost of work : Rs. 1,84,21,272.00/- (Including 18% GST)	
Name of work : Retrofitment of high capacity high tensile CBC on wagons at JHSW.	
Earnest Money : Rs. 3,68,400/-	Time of completion : Thirty Six Months
Online tender closing date and time : 02.11.2026 at 16:00 Hrs.	

Detailed information about tender and tender format in available at website www.ireps.gov.in 2313/26 (C)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONC

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Firoj Ali@Vicky** S/o: Mohd. Basir, R/o: H. No. E-59/727, Kalander Colony, Dilshad Garden, Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 30/2026, U/s: 21(C)/25/29 NDPS Act, Date : 21.02.2026,** registered at P.S.: Crime Branch, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Firoj Ali@Vicky** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Firoj Ali@Vicky** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Firoj Ali@Vicky** accused **FIR No.: 30/2026, U/s: 21(C)/25/29 NDPS Act,** registered at P.S.: Crime Branch, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **17.11.2026.**

By Order
Sh. Vineet Kumar
Special Judge (NDPS)
Shahdara, Room No. 11, Second Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/14316/CRIME/2026
(Court Matter)

News at a glance

Russia hammer India 8-0 in women's friendly

KOLKATA: India suffered a 0-8 defeat to a clinical Russia in their second women's international football friendly here on Sunday.

Having offered resistance for much of the first half in the 0-4 loss in the first friendly, the Blue Tigresses were overwhelmed this time, conceding five goals before the interval itself. Darina Ishmukhametova, Marine Achoian and Natalia Mashina scored twice each, while Daiana Kishmakhova and Elizaveta Semenova also found the net for Russia.

Chero Archers trounce Kakatiya Knights in APL

HYDERABAD: Chero Archers trounced Kakatiya Knights 6-0 and continued their strong start to the second season of Archery Premier League here on Sunday.

Led by veteran Atanu Das, Chero Archers made it three wins out of four matches so far. The Kakatiya Knights now have two wins and as many defeats so far. The Knights made a significant change to their starting XI with Austrian compound star Nico Wiener making way for Shivshankar Landkar.

Australia takes control of 1st cricket Test vs South Africa

DURBAN: Pat Cummins claimed 3-54 as Australia took a 139-run lead against South Africa at stumps on day three of the first cricket Test here on Sunday.

A collective bowling effort from Australia saw South Africa bowled out for 284 in its first innings – Mitchell Starc (2-63), Josh Hazlewood (2-54) and Nathan Lyon (2-58) took a brace each. Australia had scored 390 runs in its first innings with Matt Renshaw hitting a career-best 190 to help the visitors recover from a precarious 124-6.

'I'M GRATEFUL OUR PATHS CROSSED'



Aneet Padda remembered her 'Shakti Shalini' co-star Nana Patekar



MUMBAI: Aneet Padda paid homage to her 'Shakti Shalini' co-star Nana Patekar, remembering him as an honest and unapologetic personality who lived life on his own terms.

'Shakti Shalini', the next instalment in Maddock Films' horror-comedy universe, will feature the 'Saiyaara' star alongside Patekar. The film will be among the last screen appearances of the veteran actor, who died in Goa on Thursday following a heart attack. He was 75.

In a recent post on her 'Instagram Stories', Padda said the opportunity to work with him early in her career was an experience she would cherish for the rest of her life.

"The first time I met Nana Patekar sir, I barely spoke. I think I was just taking it all in. To sit across from someone so honest, so unfiltered, so unapologetically himself was an experience in itself. He was someone who lived life on his own terms, chose simplicity over the noise of fame and reminded you what it truly meant to be an actor. Listening to him speak, watching him work and simply being around him was a lesson I will always carry with me," she wrote.

THE OPPORTUNITY TO WORK WITH HIM EARLY IN HER CAREER WAS AN EXPERIENCE SHE WOULD CHERISH FOR THE REST OF HER LIFE

The actress said that watching Patekar work and listening to him speak had been a lesson she would always carry with her. "Looking back, I realise how precious those moments were. That one of his last films is with me still leaves me without words. It feels surreal. I'm grateful that our paths crossed, even if only for a short while and I'll carry it for the rest of my life. Rest in peace, Sir," Padda said.

Known for his intense screen presence, distinctive voice and ability to portray complex characters, Patekar built a reputation as one of Hindi cinema's most versatile performers.

'Shakti Shalini' is expected to be released in theatres in March 2027. PTI

2027 GRAMMY AWARDS

'Dhurandhar 2' soundtrack submitted for consideration



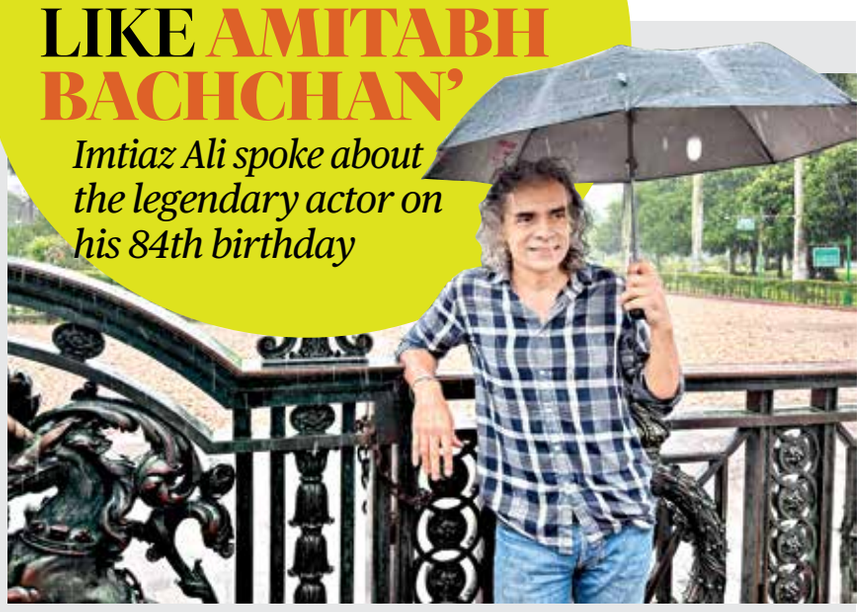
MUMBAI: The chartbuster soundtrack of Ranveer Singh-starrer 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge' has been submitted for consideration at the 2027 Grammy Awards across eight categories, production banner 'B62 Studios' announced.

The studio, founded by filmmaker Aditya Dhar and his brother Lokesh, is planning a campaign seeking international recognition for the music composed by Shashwat Sachdev. 'B62 Studios' shared the news on social media on Friday.

"'Dhurandhar: The Revenge' for your GRAMMY consideration. Thank you for all the love #ForYourConsideration #Grammys #RecordingAcademy #FYC." PTI

'THERE NOBODY LIKE AMITABH BACHCHAN'

Imtiaz Ali spoke about the legendary actor on his 84th birthday



MUMBAI: There can never be another Amitabh Bachchan, said filmmaker Imtiaz Ali, who considers himself fortunate to have been born in an era defined by the legendary actor and hopes to work with him on a film someday.

Bachchan, one of Indian cinema's biggest stars with a career spanning more than five decades, turned 84 on Sunday. "That there is nobody like Amitabh Bachchan and there never will be. I will categorise myself as a person who was born in the Amitabh Bachchan era in India," Ali told PTI.

The 55-year-old filmmaker said he initially believed he would never get the chance to work with the veteran actor, given his towering stature, but changed his mind after directing him in an advertisement. "When I came into the film industry, I thought I'd never work with Amitabh Bachchan because he's just like... I don't know what I can say to him. But I had the good fortune of doing an ad film with him. And then I realised, 'No, no. I can work with this gentleman and I'd love to, like any director'. Hopefully, someday I'll work with him," he said.

ALI INITIALLY BELIEVED HE'D NEVER GET THE CHANCE TO WORK WITH THE VETERAN ACTOR

Ali was speaking on the sidelines of Whistling Woods International's annual cinema festival, 'Celebrate Cinema'26' where he had participated in a session centred on his film 'Main Wapas Aaunga'.

Known for films such as 'Jab We Met', 'Rockstar', 'Tamasha' and 'Love Aaj Kal', Ali is marking several personal and professional milestones this year. His recent film, 'Main Wapas Aaunga', has performed well at the box office; his daughter Ida recently got engaged and he has completed 25 years in the film industry. PTI

Nicolas Cage criticises Amazon over AI



LOS ANGELES: Nicolas Cage criticised 'Amazon' over its alleged use of artificial intelligence, saying he refused to sign a waiver allowing the technology to be used on his series 'Spider-Noir' and may not work with the studio again.

Cage made the remarks during a panel at New York Comic Con on Saturday, where he also hinted that he would feature in the upcoming fifth season of HBO's crime anthology series 'True Detective', reported 'Variety'.

THE 'SPIDER-NOIR' STAR SAID HE MAY NOT WORK WITH THE STUDIO AGAIN

"'Amazon' is a very AI-friendly company, to the tune of 50 billion dollars invested in 'OpenAI'. I am not an AI-friendly actor, so it's like, connect those dots! I'm not a member of their club. I didn't sign the waiver to let him use AI on 'Spider Noir'. I'm probably not going to be working with that studio again, but that's okay," Cage said.

'Spider-Noir', based on Marvel's 'Spider-Man Noir' comics, features Cage as Ben Reilly, a seasoned private investigator in 1930s New York who is forced to confront his past as the city's only superhero following a personal tragedy. It was released in May on Amazon's streaming service 'Prime Video'. The live-action series was cancelled by the streamer after one season last month despite it receiving 11 Emmy nominations, the highest number among the streamer's programmes that year.

Cage, however, said he was keen to explore more television projects. PTI

'Drishyam: The Conclusion' grosses Rs 42.71 crore



MUMBAI: Ajay Devgn-starrer 'Drishyam: The Conclusion' remained unstoppable at the global office, earning Rs 42.71 crore on Day 9 to take its total collection to Rs 452.14 crore. According to the makers, the film registered a 72 per cent increase on Saturday, which reflects the continued audience interest in the latest instalment of the crime thriller franchise.

THE FILM INSTALMENT WAS RELEASED IN THEATRES ON OCTOBER 2

"With a stellar Day 9 collection of Rs 42.71 crore worldwide, 'Drishyam: The Conclusion' has taken its total worldwide collection to a phenomenal Rs 452.14 crore, while its overseas earnings have already crossed the Rs 100 crore mark. With its box office momentum showing no signs of slowing down, the film is now on track to cross the Rs 500 crore mark worldwide in just 10 days," the makers said.

Directed by Abhishek Pathak, the third and final instalment of the franchise was released in theatres on October 2 and received largely positive reviews, with critics highlighting its performances, suspense and twists.

The film sees Devgn return as Vijay Salgaonkar, who once again finds himself in a cat-and-mouse game with the law. PTI

'Don't overlook their contribution'

MRUNAL EXPRESSED HER DISPLEASURE OVER THE TROLLING OF KATRINA KAIF AND KRITI SANON



MUMBAI: Mrunal Thakur came out in support of actresses Katrina Kaif and Kriti Sanon, who faced massive online trolling recently, saying people should respect their choices and not overlook their contributions to the film industry.

A section of social media users last month trolled Kaif over her appearance and weight gain following the birth of her son, Vihaan. Before that, Sanon was heavily criticised over her choice of clothing in an advertisement for a jewellery brand during a traditional festival.

Asked about female actors being subjected to public scrutiny over their appearance and clothing, Thakur expressed her displeasure at those judging the two Bollywood stars.

"It's their life, it's their choice and everyone has a right to enjoy their phase of their life. And who are we? People who are judging all these iconic women, do we forget how amazing work (they have done) and the contribution towards the industry and business of both these women? Be it Kriti and Katrina, they are running a business not just in India but everywhere in the UK and all. I think people should not comment on anyone else. People are crazy. What else to say?" Mrunal told PTI.

'IT'S THEIR LIFE, IT'S THEIR CHOICE AND EVERYONE HAS A RIGHT TO ENJOY THEIR PHASE OF THEIR LIFE,' SAYS THAKUR

Thakur said women have always been judged, while pointing out that men also face similar scrutiny. "Women are always judged and when are they not judged? But not just women; even men are judged," she said.

Thakur was speaking on the sidelines of the promotions of her recently released film 'Pooja Meri Jaan', which revolves around Pooja, a free-spirited girl who rejects a sudden proposal from her longtime friend Aniket. He subsequently dies by suicide, leaving behind an email blaming her for his death. PTI